RADIANCE

PROLOGUE

We look out for each other in Farhome. And we keep to ourselves. It's better that way.

It's peacetime. In fact, it always has been, as far as almost anyone alive can remember. It has been many generations since the War of Shadows. We barely even remember how long it's been since we adopted an isolationist way of living. It's bright in Farhome. The dark out there in the wide world can worry about itself. We're safe here.

Until one day we weren't.

We ignored the darkness as long as we could. "It ebbs and flows," we told ourselves. Then, multiple attacks within a single month. Those on the edge of Farhome report encroaching darkness. We could see it from home. The sky growing dark in the south and east. Farhome's light has diminished severely. Something must be done. We must discover the source of this great darkness and put a stop to it, before we are all destroyed or corrupted.

The problem is we've been a peaceful society for so long that we have no heroes. Luminaries is the word we used to use. We're fresh out. But the darkness grows. We must send the best we have. We'll pull people from professions that give them some useful skills for a quest such as this — hunters, scorchwrights, wayfarers, menders.

But we'll also need to choose new Luminaries. We need beings who generate an abundance of light. High Radiance, as it's referred to. It'll be a dark and dangerous journey. The heroes will encounter evils so dark that their own light will begin to diminish, and their minds wander on a path to corruption. They will need light as a resource to fight back against the Shadow enemies and cross dangerous lands.

Which means we must send the most virtuous among us. Virtue is what determines an individual's inherent light source.

We send our new Luminaries and pray. We'll know the outcome soon enough, by watching the sky.

GAME OVERVIEW

Radiance is a strategic adventure card game for 1-2 players. A modular setup allows you to choose a combination of luminary and profession (each providing half your deck of player cards and a skill mat) and a Shade to go up against. Each round, you'll play your multi-use cards to a specific role, resolving their Action, Attack, Explore, or Element/Boosters. You'll work your way to the Southeast, exploring dangerous locations as you go. On your travels you'll encounter dangerous enemies trying to corrupt you to darkness. You'll need to manage your precious light resource to play cards and power your actions. You'll spend XP to unlock new skills, recruit and upgrade cards, increase your light production, and grow your capacity to carry beacons, a limited resource that helps you navigate the ever-darkening lands — yet holds a corrupting power of its own.

Radiance is a game of constant tension as the player desperately tries to manage tempo. Move too quickly and you'll find yourself in deep waters before you're ready. Linger too long, however, and the enemies will hone in on your location, forcing you to abandon the fight against their growing darkness and allowing the evil powers to progress their own treacherous plans.

Rulebook note: The rules laid out in the following pages are for solo play. For 2 players, follow the additional instructions for the Twin Flames variant (see p.91).

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PROLOGUE 2
GAME OVERVIEW 3
COMPONENTS 6
CARD ANATOMY 8
SETUP 12
I: CREATING YOUR LUMINARY 14
II: STARTING CORRUPTION AND GROWTH . . . 16
III: ENEMY PREPARATIONS 18
IV: SETTING UP THE WORLD 20
V: FINAL SETUP (AND DIFFICULTY) 21
KEY CONCEPTS 22
AREAS OF PLAY 22
"X" VALUES 23
GROWTH 23
EFFECTS 26
TRAITS 32
YOUR ECHO 33
SKILLS 34
ATTACHING CARDS 36
ATTACKS, WOUNDS AND HEALING 36
RESHUFFLING/DEPLETING YOUR DECK 37
BEACONS AND SEARCH ACTIONS 38
KEYWORDS 39
GAMEPLAY 42
OVERVIEW 42
WINNING AND LOSING 42
PLAYING A ROUND 42
1. STAGING PHASE 44
2. ACTION SET PHASE 46

3. ENGAGEMENT PHASE 48
4. DARKNESS PHASE 50
5. EXPLORE PHASE 54
6. ATTACK PHASE 61
7. DEFEND PHASE 63
8. REFRESH PHASE 64
SHADE ENCOUNTER 66
SHADE CARDS 66
SHADE REVEAL AND SHADE INFLUENCE 67
WINNING THE GAME 67
THE FINAL LOCATION 69
ADJUSTING THE DIFFICULTY 70
PRECONFIGURED DIFFICULTY SETTINGS 70
CUSTOMIZING DIFFICULTY 73
COMPANIONS 76
SHADOWS 78
ADDITIONAL MODES OF PLAY 80
BLITZ 80
SIDE QUESTS 82
LIMITED QUESTS 85
LOCATION BARONS 87
TWIN FLAMES (2-PLAYER CO-OP) 91
LORE 98
FARHOME 98
THE LUMINARIES 102
THE PROFESSIONS 110
THE SHADES 118
ICONOGRAPHY 126
CREDITS 127

COMPONENTS

48 Player Cards

48 Locations

Beacon Mat

4 Luminary Mats

8 Companions

4 Profession Mats

Growth Track Mat

*37 Side Quests

*12 Barons

*Modules Reference Card

*Quest Board Mat

*8 Limited Quests

*Extra Cubes
(2 player)

*Deluxe Edition only

28 Dusk Enemies

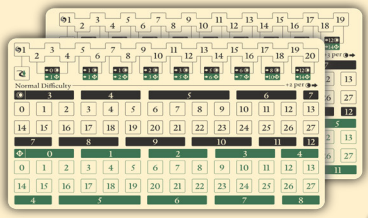
20 Doom Enemies

4 Shades

4 Shadows

Shade Influence Mat

15 Treacheries



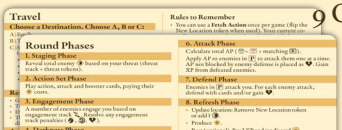
Corruption Track mat

New Location Token

12 Skill Cubes

16 Cubes

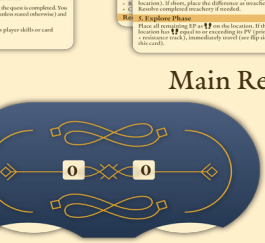
9 Path and 9 Obstacle Tokens



Main Reference Card

15 Threat Tokens

XP Tokens
15 of value 1/3
5 of value 5/10



*2 AP Tracker Dials

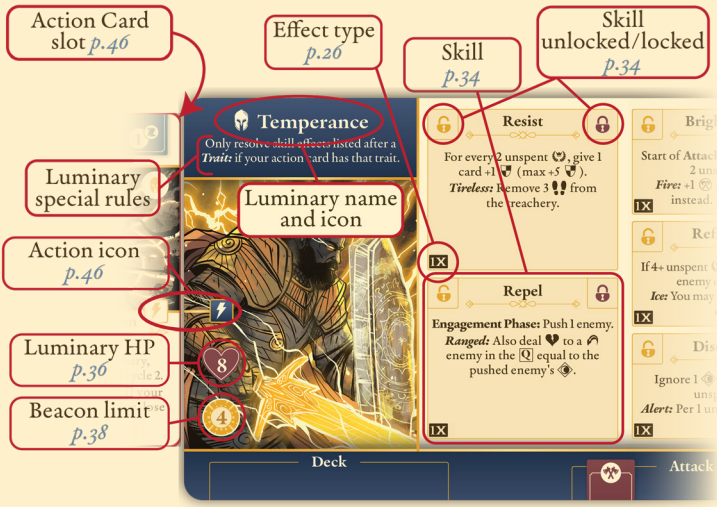
Progress Tokens
35 of value 1/3
5 of value 5/10

Wound Tokens
25 of value 1/3
5 of value 5/10

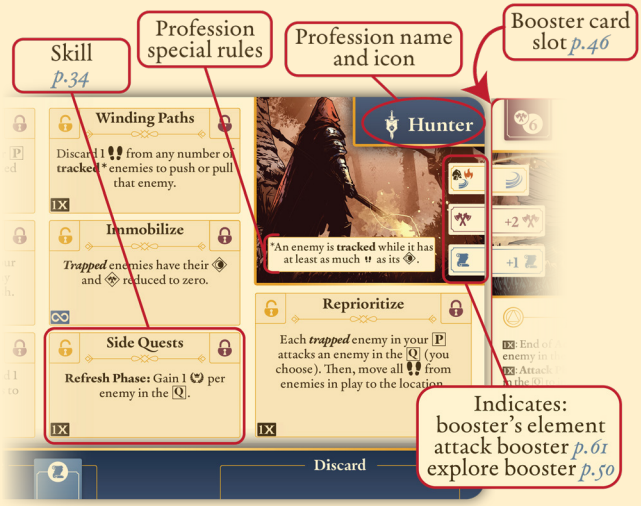
CARD ANATOMY

PLAYER CARDS

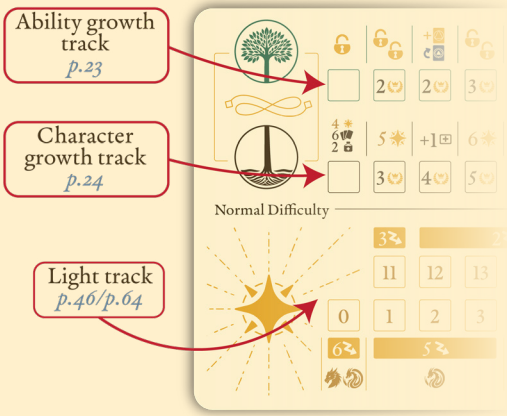
LUMINARY MAT



PROFESSION MAT

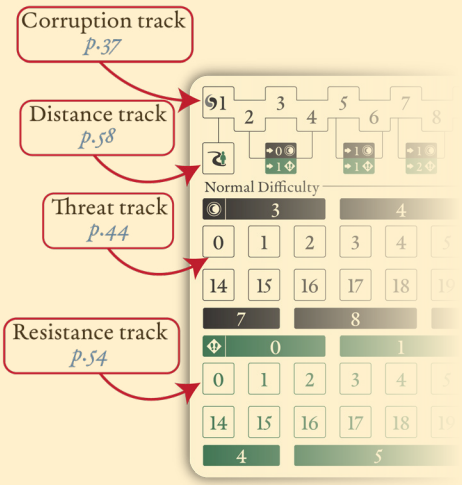


GROWTH MAT

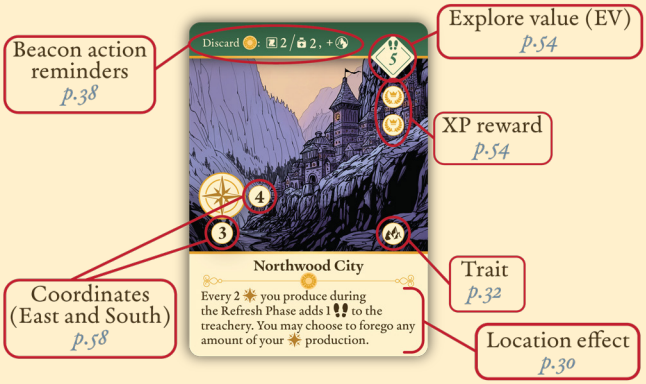


ENEMY CARDS

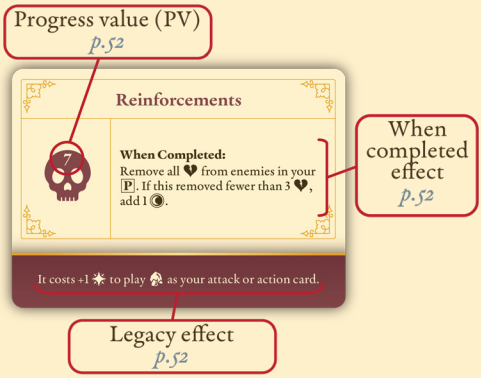
CORRUPTION MAT



LOCATION CARDS



TREACHERY CARDS



ADDITIONAL COMPONENTS

- **Companions** *p.76*
- **Shades** *p.66*
- **Shadows** *p.78*
- **Shade influence mat** *p.60*
- **Beacon mat** *p.38*
- **Deluxe edition extras** *p.82-91*

SETUP

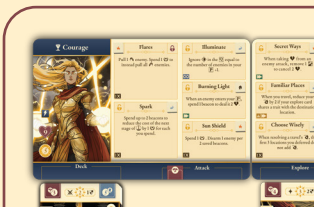
For setup, we'll walk you through 4 main steps:

I: Creating Your Luminary,

II: Starting Corruption and Growth,

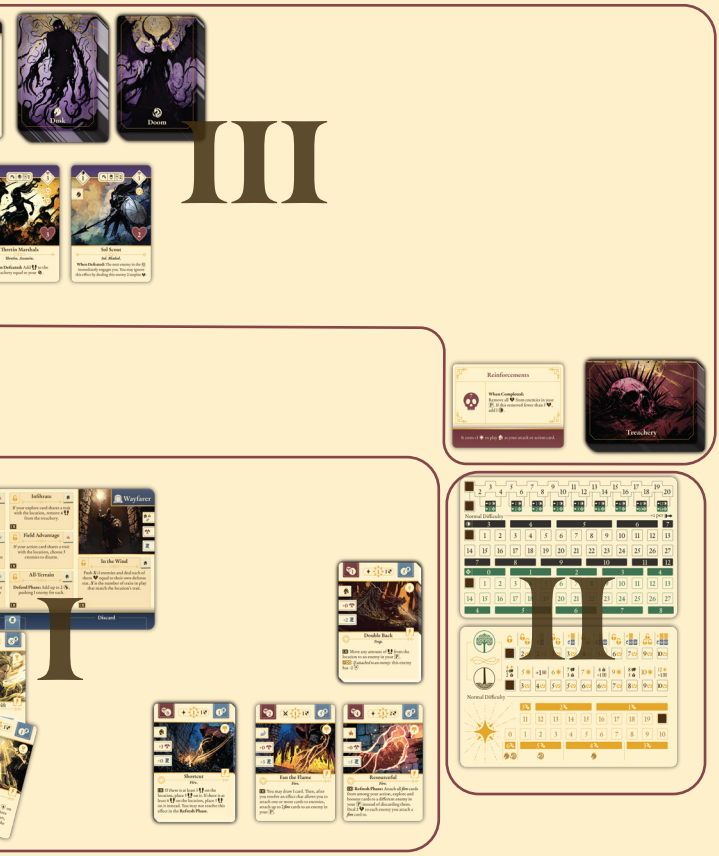
III: Enemy Preparations,

IV: Setting Up the World.



The setup given here is for the standard “blaze” difficulty. Ways to adjust the setup to fine tune the difficulty are provided on p.70.

Throughout setup, we will also give recommendations for your first play of the game, including combinations of cards to select along with a few tips that can be used to give you a leg up on your first play. These recommendations will be found in dark blue boxes, just like this one.



I: CREATING YOUR LUMINARY

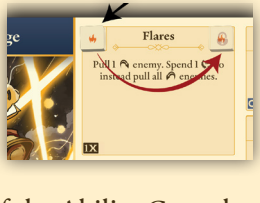
During each play of Radiance, you will create a character by picking both a luminary (hero) and a profession, which can be mixed and matched. Set up your luminary as follows:

1. Choose a luminary and profession. Collect the skill mats for each, placing them next to each other immediately in front of you with the luminary mat on the left.

> For your first play, one of the following combinations will provide a powerful but less complex build.
>
> - Courage (luminary) as a Wayfarer (profession)
> - Justice (luminary) as a Wayfarer (profession)
> - Temperance (luminary) as a Scorchwright (profession)

2. Shuffle the 12 skill cubes and randomly place 1 cube on each of the yellow unlocked icons in the top-left corner of each skill. Place these cubes "ready side up" so that the element without an "x" through it is shown.

3. Choose 1 of the 2 skills from the leftmost column on your luminary mat to unlock, moving its skill cube to reveal the unlocked icon and cover the locked icon. (This skill is unlocked during setup of the Ability Growth Track on p.16).



4. Locate the 6 cards belonging to your chosen luminary and the 6 cards belonging to your chosen profession, as indicated by the character icon on the player cards. Flip the cards to their basic side, labeled with the icon, and shuffle the 12 cards together to form your deck. Place your deck below the space labeled "Deck" at the bottom of your luminary mat.

5. Draw 7 cards from the top of your deck. Choose one of them to place in the explore slot below your profession mat, ignoring its light cost . Keep the other 6 cards in your hand.

6. Choose your **hobby**, a different profession from which you will gain cards as you progress through the game (see p.23). Collect the 6 cards from that profession flipped to their basic side . Then shuffle them and place this stack of cards to the right of your player area. Deal 2 cards ( ) next to the stack to form the **hobby card market**.

7. Create a **permanent booster source deck,** from which you will gain boosters for permanent use as you grow (see p.25). To do so, select an additional unused profession and take the 6 player cards and place them in a stack to your right (again on their basic side .)

II: STARTING CORRUPTION AND GROWTH

As the game progresses, your hero will grow in strength, but so will the threats against you. This progress will be tracked using 2 additional mats, which are set up as follows:

1. Collect the **corruption mat** and the **growth mat**. Place them with the side labeled "normal difficulty" facing up to the right side of your player area, one above the other.
2. Place cubes on the following spaces on the corruption mat:
    a. The 1 space on the corruption track ,
    b. The left-most space on the distance track ,
    c. The 0 space on the threat track ,
    d. The 0 space on the resistance track .
3. Place cubes on the following spaces on the growth mat:
    a. The left-most space on both growth tracks ,,
    b. The 20 space on the light track, .

The cubes on the corruption mat will climb their tracks throughout the game, both adding to the difficulty and number of enemies faced and making future travel more challenging.

But as you defeat more enemies and gain experience, you can also spend that experience to grow in strength, progressing up the growth tracks. At the beginning of the game, the benefits above your cubes on the growth tracks are active.

The ability growth track will give you access to more skills, new cards and upgraded abilities. To start the

game, you have access to one skill, which you already unlocked during the “Creating Your Luminary” step.

The character growth track provides other benefits, with your starting benefits providing you with a light regeneration of 4 per round, a hand size of 6, and a rest value of 2, which will be discussed in future sections.

III: ENEMY PREPARATIONS

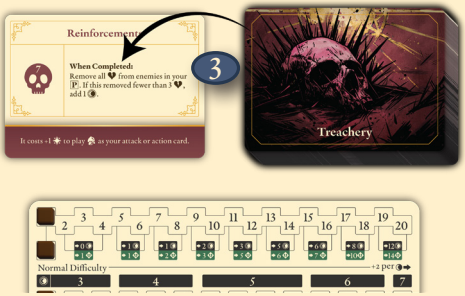
As you prepare for your adventure, the enemy is also marshalling its strength. There will be enemies everywhere you travel, along with an opposing **Shade**, their leader, that will be influencing the world as you travel. Set up the enemies and their plans as follows:

1. Sort the enemy cards by their cardback into two decks, Dusk enemies and Doom enemies. Shuffle each deck and place them face-down (separately) near the top of the table, leaving room for enemy discard piles.

2. Reveal a card from the Dusk enemy deck and place it below the enemy decks. Continue revealing cards in this manner until you have revealed a total of at least 3 darkness. For each card revealed after the first (if needed): place fast enemies to the right of all enemies already placed, and slow enemies to the left.

*This row of cards forms the **quest area** Q of your game, which will be discussed in more detail shortly.*

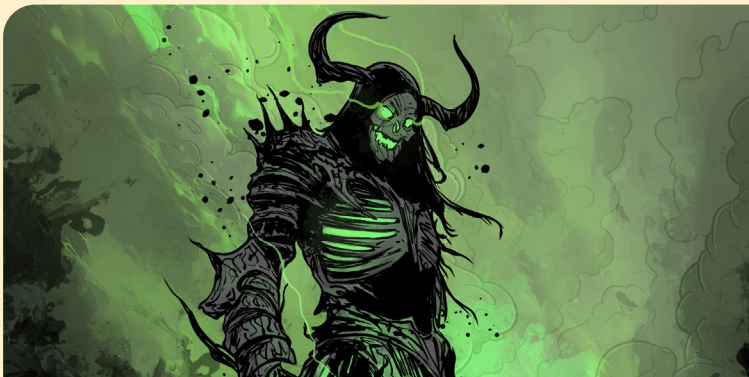
3. Gather all the treachery cards and shuffle them into a deck, placing it face down to the right and above the corruption mat. Reveal the top treachery and place it face up to the left of the treachery deck. This is the first active treachery.



4. Select a Shade to face for this play. Flip the selected Shade card to its text side and place it near the enemy deck.

For your first game, we recommend selecting either Greed or Pride as your Shade.

Your chosen Shade's card will provide you with the way the shade will affect your game. It also details when the Shade is "revealed" and joins in the battle. Additionally, it will provide you with the Shade's corruption ֍ and completed treachery limits, which are loss conditions of the game discussed shortly.



IV: SETTING UP THE WORLD

As you proceed through your quest, you will travel to new locations, with the final goal of finding and defeating the Shade. Set up the locations and world you will be exploring as follows:

1. Create the location deck. To do so, find the **Farhome** location card and set it aside. Shuffle all remaining location cards into a deck and place it to the left of your play area.

Note: If you selected Greed as your Shade, his card instructs you to remove certain locations from the deck at this point.

2. Place the **Farhome** location to the right of the location deck and place the New Location token on top of it with the token's "Ready" side face up.
3. Place the beacon mat to the left and a bit below the location deck with the "Ready" side face-up, leaving room above for a stack of cards.
4. Place the Shade influence mat to the left of the beacon mat and place a cube on the top left space, leaving room above for the location discard pile.
5. Place all tokens (XP, Progress, Wounds, Threat, Path and Obstacle) in a general supply below the location deck.

V: FINAL SETUP (AND DIFFICULTY)

The difficulty level of Radiance can be fine tuned to fit your experience and play style.

You can find the details of this process beginning on p.70, including instructions for modifying the above setup or adding additional steps, such as playing with a Companion or adding powerful enemies, called Shadows, to the opposing forces.

For your first game, we suggest playing on either Ember or Spark difficulty (for a more detailed explanation, see p.70). In either case, you will gain a bit of extra experience to start the game, along with getting a Companion to bring along.

- For Ember difficulty, gain 6 XP during setup and select a 3-strength companion to aid you on your quest.
- For Spark difficulty, gain 3 XP during setup and select a 2-strength companion to aid you on your quest.

Spending experience on character growth is further detailed on p.23.

Companions and their setup are described on p.76.

KEY CONCEPTS

The concepts in the following pages are things you need to know to play the game, but do not fit neatly in the rules explaining the flow of how to play a round. When learning the game, we recommend at least skimming the concepts in this section as an introduction. Then, when you move on to learning the flow of a round, you can reference these concepts as needed.

AREAS OF PLAY

There are 2 areas of play where enemies will be present, the **Quest area** [Q] and the **Player area** [P].

The quest area [Q] is where enemies are revealed, and they form a queue where the right side is the front. Enemies in the quest area do not attack you and cannot be attacked. They wait in this area before engaging you.

The player area [P] is where enemies move to engage with you. When in the player area, enemies can be attacked during the Attack phase and will also attack you, provided they are still present during the Defend phase.

When an enemy moves from the quest area [Q] to your player area [P] for any reason, they go to the left side, or "the back" of the queue.

When an enemy moves from your player area [P] to the quest area [Q], fast enemies move to the right, or front, of the [Q], whereas slow enemies move to the far left, or back, of the queue.

When you are instructed to pull an enemy, move it from the quest area [Q] to your player area [P]. If you are instructed to push an enemy, move it from your player area [P] to the quest area [Q], as described in the previous paragraphs.

"X" VALUES

Some effects refer to values of "*X*" in their text. Text on the card or skill will tell you what *X* refers to. If there is ever a situation where whatever *X* is referring to does not exist or is a value of zero, the value of *X* defaults to 1.

GROWTH

As you gain XP throughout the game, you can spend it to strengthen your Luminary by moving up the two growth tracks: The Ability Growth track and the Character Growth track. This is known as **growth** or **growing.**

To grow, pay the XP cost of the next space to the right of your cube on the growth track you want to advance on by taking XP tokens from your possession and returning them to the general supply. Then, advance your cube one space on that track, gaining the benefits printed on the new space where your cube now sits.

You can grow at almost any time during a round, though there are a few exceptions. You cannot grow if:

- You are in the middle of resolving an effect,
- You are in the process of applying AP to enemies in the Attack Phase, or
- You are in the process of resolving enemy attacks in the Defend Phase.

ABILITY GROWTH TRACK

The Ability Growth Track represents your luminary's potential to learn new skills and perfect their abilities during their adventures, and the benefits on this track will allow you to unlock new skills, gain new cards, and upgrade cards you already have.

When advancing on the Ability Growth Track, resolve your new benefits immediately, and only once.

+: Recruit the shown number of cards by gaining new cards from your hobby market (see p.15). For each new card gained, choose 1 of the 3 cards in the hobby market (the 2 next to the deck and the top card of the deck) and gain it to hand. Then choose one of the remaining two cards to move to the bottom of the hobby deck. Fill the hobby market so 3 cards are again showing (or 2 if there are only 2 cards left in the hobby deck and market).

: Upgrade the shown number of cards by selecting basic cards **in your hand** and flipping them to their advanced side. Once upgraded, a card will remain on its Advanced side for the remainder of the game. Advanced cards have much more powerful effects but also have a higher light cost .

: Unlock the shown number of skills on your player mats by moving the token at the top of the skill from the left side to the right side to reveal the unlocked icon , and covering up the locked icon .

You may only unlock a skill that is orthogonally adjacent to a skill that is already unlocked, with two exceptions:

- The two skills in the leftmost column on your luminary mat are considered adjacent to each other, and each is also considered adjacent to the two skills closest to it in the second column.
- The rightmost skill on your profession mat is considered adjacent to all 3 skills in the column to the left of it.

Note: During setup, you place your cube on the first space of the Ability Growth Track, which allows you to unlock 1 skill from the leftmost column on your luminary mat.

CHARACTER GROWTH TRACK

The Character Growth Track represents your

luminary improving their character and virtue, which most notably improves their Radiance (how virtuous you are determines how much light you radiate). Character growth is foundational to your luminary's success; all the flashy skills and abilities in the world would be impossible to wield effectively if you did not have resolute character and integrity.

Advancing on the Character Growth Track improves your character's ability to recover during the Refresh Phase (see p.64) by increasing your hand size, increasing your light production, making your rest more effective, and allowing you to equip new permanent boosters.

For , , and , your current stat is the largest value shown above your cube on the track, or the first instance of that icon to its left.

X : You will draw up to a hand of *X* cards during the Refresh Phase.

X : You will gain *X* light on your growth track mat during the Refresh Phase.

X : When you choose to take a Physical rest (spending 3XP) during the Refresh Phase, you can remove up to *X* wounds from your Luminary mat.

+1 : You immediately equip an additional permanent booster card. To do so, choose any 1 card from your permanent booster source deck (see p.15) and place it adjacent to the right side of your profession mat. **You must immediately pay the light cost depicted on your selected card plus the light cost of any already-equipped permanent boosters that have the same element (, ,) as the one you just added.**

If you have multiple permanent boosters unlocked, overlap them so that you can see the element and booster values along the left edge of each card.

Permanent boosters are always on their basic ◎ side and remain next to your player mat for the rest of the game. They **DO NOT** contribute the traits printed on them.

During the Action Set Phase, place your chosen booster card each round on top of these permanent boosters, offset so that you can see all the booster values.

EFFECTS

An **effect** is a chunk of text that causes the game state to change. They make things happen. Effects are found on player cards (as their actions), player skills, enemies, locations and treacheries.

Typically, a card will contain a single effect, though some cards can have multiple effects. Skills are always a single, combined effect.

Effects only apply during the round in which they are triggered, unless the effect specifies otherwise.

Player effects are effects written on player cards/skills.

EFFECT TYPES

All player effects are one of three types: Passive ∞, Once-Per-Round 1X, or Unrestricted ▶▶.

- **Passive effects** ∞ are ongoing effects that modify or change the game in some way. Passive effects are considered to be constantly updating, so if the game state changes, the passive effect recognizes the change immediately as the change takes place. There is no limit to how often a passive effect can affect the game in a given round. **Passive effects are always considered mandatory** so must be resolved whenever their conditions are met.

- **Once-Per-Round effects** 1X are able to be resolved once per round. A small exception exists in that a 1X skill can be used twice under certain circumstances, as

described in the skills section (see p.35). IX effects are optional by default, but if they are accompanied by the triangular icon △IX:, they are mandatory, and must be resolved the first time in a round that the conditions are met. If there are no conditions stated, the player can choose when to resolve the effect.

- **Unrestricted effects** ▶▶ can be resolved as many times as desired in a given round, provided you meet any required conditions the effect may have. These effects are optional by default, but mandatory unrestricted effects (given by this icon △▶:) must be resolved every time their stated conditions are met.

RESPONSE EFFECTS

Some effects are response effects, which means they require a **triggering event** to happen before they can be resolved. Response effects generally have the words ***when***, ***whenever***, *or* ***after*** in the text of the effect. A **triggering event** refers to something in the game that takes place and results in a change to the game state or ongoing effects active at the time. Each response effect can only be resolved once per triggering event.

EAGER EFFECTS (✓IX:, ✓▶:, ✓∞:)

Eager effects are able to be resolved even outside the normal rules which can limit other effects. This includes card action effects not on this round's action card (such as Wisdom's ***trances*** and Hunter's ***traps***), as well as skills that are not unlocked and/or active (such as Mender's **Dark Past** skill). Consult the effect's text to know if there are additional conditions that must be met in order for the Eager effect to be resolved.

Eager IX and ▶▶ effects can also be **mandatory**, and are depicted with the following icons: ✓△IX:, ✓△▶:. Recall that Passive effects are by default considered Mandatory, so Eager Passive effects ✓∞: are also considered Eager Mandatory Passive effects.

PHASE RESOLUTION TIMING

Some player effects (skills and card actions) may include a **phase restriction**. This is shown by the phase name appearing in bold followed by a colon before the effect. An effect with a phase restriction can only be resolved in the specified phase. You can choose to resolve effects with phase restrictions at any time during the phase, with the exception that if the effect begins with the stipulation "Start of..." or "End of..." the phase. In these cases, the effect must be the first or last thing you do in that phase, respectively. If resolving multiple Start Of or multiple End Of effects in the same phase, you choose the order of resolving these effects.

> DX: **Attack Phase:** Increase your ♈ by the number of enemies in your P.

EFFECT RESOLUTION TIMING

In general, you can resolve an effect any time during the round, with these exceptions:

- You must follow an effect's phase restriction if it has one, or any other timing restrictions it lists.
- In general, you must resolve an effect completely before moving on to a different effect. Exceptions to this are effects that say they resolve "when" or "whenever" something else happens, as well as relevant passive ∞ effects. In these cases, resolve the "when" or passive effect immediately after its trigger occurs, interrupting a different effect if needed. After fully resolving the interrupting "when" or passive effect, return to the original effect and finish resolving it.
- You cannot resolve an effect if you are in the middle of carrying out a game action, meaning any kind of upkeep the game requires of you, such as discarding your action set or producing light in the Refresh Phase or revealing enemies in the Staging Phase.

We encourage you to not stress too much about this rule. Usually you will play this correctly intuitively. The biggest example where this rule is important is the Mender profession's **Enduring Hope** *skill.* **Enduring Hope** *is a passive skill that says, "The element of your echo is also active." When you discard your action set, this is considered one single game action, even though you are discarding 3 cards. This is an important distinction for Mender's* **Enduring Hope**, *because if you could pause after each card is discarded,* **Enduring Hope** *can be overpowered due to the flexibility of your element changing with each discard.*

TIMING: OTHER INTRICACIES AND CASES

If resolving an effect that discards multiple cards and you have a passive "when" or "whenever" effect that triggers when a card is discarded, resolve the "when" effect after each discarded card individually, as you go. Don't wait until all the cards are discarded; resolve them as they happen.

If an effect says it resolves "after" something else happens, do not interrupt the effect that triggered it. Finish resolving the triggering effect, and then **immediately** resolve the "after" effect.

When you resolve an effect, resolve all of the effect's text, or as much as you are able to. Skip parts of the effect if you are not able to resolve them.

Some parts of the effect state that you "may" do them, in which case this specific part of the effect is voluntary.

If part of an effect is followed by the word "then", you must be able to fully resolve the text that comes before it in order to resolve the "then" part of the effect. For example, Wisdom's ***Prep*** skill says: "Exhaust this skill. Then, up to twice: Swap 2 skills' cubes." To resolve the "swap 2 skills' cubes" effect, you must have first exhausted this skill.

If a card has multiple effects, you can choose the order in which you resolve them. Be sure to follow any timing instructions on the effect itself, such as a phase restriction or a condition/trigger the effect responds to.

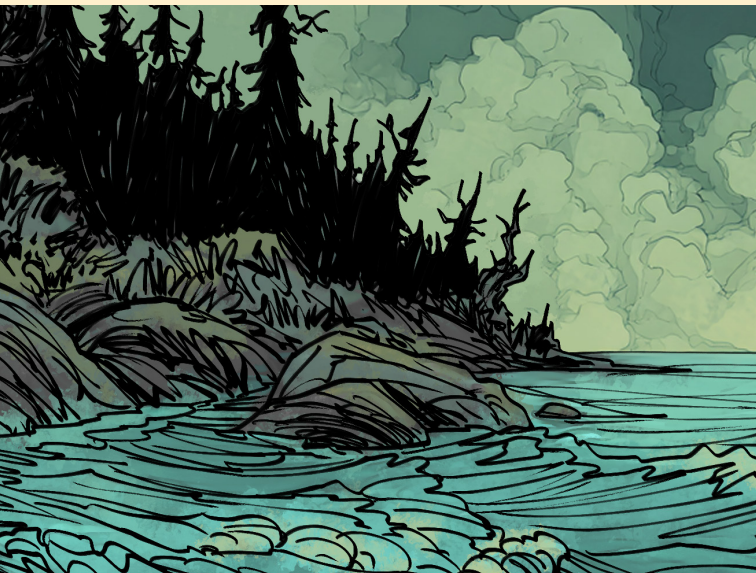
ENEMY AND LOCATION EFFECTS

Effects on enemies and locations do not have an icon indicating their type. Simply follow what the effect's text instructs you to do. If part of an enemy's effect has "P" (for player area) or "Q" (for quest area), only resolve the effect if the enemy is in that area of play.

TREACHERY EFFECTS

Treachery cards have two effects on them. The text in the middle of the card is the "When Completed" effect and resolves immediately (only once) after the treachery has accumulated progress equal to or greater than its progress value (PV). The PV is the number inside the large skull icon.

The text in the box near the bottom of treachery cards is the legacy effect. This is in play after the treachery has been completed, and is active for the rest of the game.

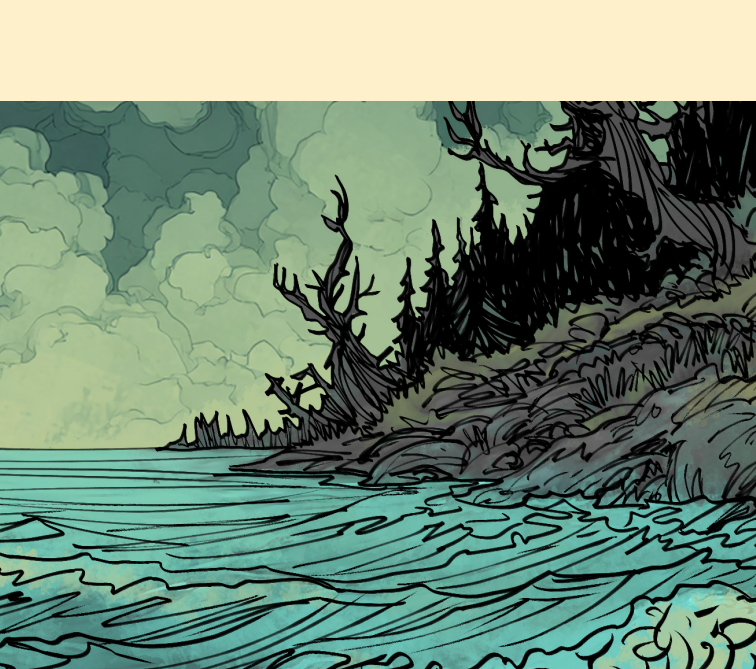


NEGATIVE EFFECTS WITH OPTIONS

Some enemy, location and treachery effects give you a choice in how to resolve them. You must choose an option that you can at least partially resolve. If you can fully resolve one of the options and only partially resolve the other option, you must choose the option you can fully resolve.

For example, if enemy effect says, "Take 1 💔 or remove 3 👣 from the location," and you only have 2 progress on the location, you are required to choose the option you can **fully** resolve, so you must choose the option of taking 1 💔, since you are unable to fully resolve removing 3 progress from the location.

This rule holds true even if it forces you to resolve an option that would cause you to lose the game. In the above example, you would need to take the 1 💔, even if you only have one HP left - again provided you only had 2 of the required 3 👣 that could be removed.



TRAITS

Location, player cards and enemies (including Shades and Shadows) can have **traits**.

Traits are bold, italicized words or icons near the top of the text boxes of player cards, enemies and location cards. Traits have no purpose on their own, but many effects in the game key off of the existence of traits.

Effects throughout the game may refer to a card with a given trait as an adjective. For example, Temperance has a card that says, "If your attack or explore card is ***hopeless***, lose 1 XP." This means your attack or explore card must have the ***hopeless*** trait to meet this condition.

Note: Location cards and the Wayfarer profession's cards have icons instead of words as traits. Treat these as you would other traits.

When an effect refers to traits in your action set, it means traits on any of the 4 cards in your action set (see p.46). If an effect refers to traits "in play", it means traits on any cards in your action set and on cards attached to enemies and locations (see p.36).

Some effects will also allow for the addition or removal of traits on cards. When traits are added or removed from a card, this change only lasts through the end of the current round. If a card attached to an enemy or location requires a trait in order for it to be attached, the card is not discarded if it loses this trait.

YOUR ECHO

Some effects will refer to your **echo.** Your echo is the card that is currently on top of your discard pile. In the case that your discard pile is empty, you do not currently have an echo.

Tracking your echo and understanding when and how it changes through your turn can often be important, especially for the Mender profession.

During play, your echo will update frequently as you will be discarding cards for various reasons. **Once you begin resolving an effect, your echo does not change until after you have fully resolved the effect.** The game essentially takes a snapshot of your echo as the effect begins to resolve, and as far as the game is concerned, it does not take a new snapshot until the effect has been fully resolved.

Example: if an effect allows you to discard 3 cards, your echo does not update until after the effect is over, even though the top card of your discard pile changes due to discarding cards. You may find it helpful to make a "temporary" discard pile so you can still see your echo during the effect.

There is one major exception to the above rule about when your echo updates. In particular, when part of an effect says "then", your echo updates before resolving the portion of the text after the written"then". Typically, the goal with effects like these is to give you more immediate control of what your echo is so you can benefit from it.

SKILLS

As you grow your character, you will gain access to more and more skills on your player mats. To be able to use these skills, you must satisfy certain conditions. A skill must be **unlocked**, **ready** and **active** to be used in most circumstances (these concepts are explained in the coming sections).

Each skill has a skill cube associated with it that is of one of three elements: earth, wind or fire.

LOCKED VS UNLOCKED

All skills start the game in their locked position, with their skill cube covering the unlocked icon in the upper left corner of the skill, leaving the locked icon visible. During setup, you will unlock a single skill and will unlock additional skills as your character grows (see p.23) by moving the skill cube to the top right corner and covering the locked icon.

A skill must be unlocked for it to be used.

READY VS EXHAUSTED

A skill is ready when its skill cube is face up, showing its element (not with an x through it) and is exhausted when the face with an x through it is showing. All skills start the game in the ready state. **Ready skills can be used for free once per turn if the skill is also unlocked and active.**

ACTIVE VS INACTIVE

A skill is always considered **active** when the element shown on its skill cube matches the element on your booster card. This is the most common way for a skill to become active. **A skill must be active for it to be used.**

If a skill is inactive, you can choose to exhaust it, flipping the skill cube to its other side to activate it until the discard step during the Refresh Phase at the end of the round.

Note: Normally a skill must be ready in order to be used. **Exhausting a skill to make it active is the one exception to this rule**; the skill will be exhausted but is able to be used for the rest of the round. After the round, you will not be able to use it unless you find a way to ready it!

Every skill provides an effect of one of three types: passive ∞, unrestricted ▶▶, or once-per-round 1X, as described in the "effect" section (see p.26).

These types of effects work as described in the "effect" section, with one exception:

A once-per-round skill 1X can be used a single time each round when it is unlocked, ready, and active. However, you can use the skill a second time in a round by exhausting it, flipping its skill cube to its exhausted side.

SPECIAL RULE: SWAPPING SKILL CUBES

The luminary Wisdom has the **Prep** skill which allows you to swap skill cubes by selecting any 2 skill cubes on your player mats and swapping their locations. When swapped, each cube maintains its current ready or exhausted state, and the skills from which the tokens were swapped also maintain their locked or unlocked state. You are simply taking one cube from its exact location and swapping it with another, also preserving their orientation.

ATTACHING CARDS

Enemy or location cards can have other cards attached to them. This refers to placing a card from your hand underneath the enemy or location with the text box revealed. If an enemy moves between the quest area Q and player area P, any attachments it has go with it. When a location with an attachment is explored or an enemy with an attachment leaves play, the attached card is discarded to your discard pile. The traits on attached cards are considered "in play" but not "in your action set."

ATTACKS, WOUNDS AND HEALING

Throughout the game, you will both deal damage to enemies and take damage from attacks and various effects. Damage taken is tracked using wound 💔 tokens, either placing them on the card that took damage or placing it on your luminary mat when the damage is done to you. Wounds can also be removed via various healing effects.

If you have wound tokens on your luminary mat equal to your printed HP, you immediately lose the game.

BEING ATTACKED BY AN ENEMY

During the Defend Phase, you will resolve attacks (one at a time) of enemies in your player area P against you, often blocking some or all of the incoming damage (see p.63). When you take unblocked damage, add 1 wound 💔 token to your luminary mat.

Immediate Attacks - If an effect says that an enemy makes an immediate attack, resolve this instantly, interrupting the normal flow of the round. Resolve the immediate attack as normal by defending it with cards and/or taking wounds. Then, return to the normal flow of the round. An enemy that makes an immediate attack still attacks you as normal during the defend phase.

DAMAGING YOURSELF AND TAKING WOUNDS

Some effects in the game say you must "deal yourself 💔" or "take 💔". These are not considered enemy attacks, even if the effect is on an enemy card. They are instead considered direct damage and **cannot be defended.** You must always take wound 💔 tokens onto your luminary mat when suffering direct damage in this way.

DEALING WOUNDS TO ENEMIES

When an effect, such as a skill or card action, instructs you to deal wounds 💔 to an enemy, this is considered direct damage. It is unaffected by enemy defense and is not considered an attack. It cannot be combined with your AP during the attack phase (see p.61).

HEALING

When an effect says "Heal *X*", remove *X* wound 💔 tokens from your luminary mat. You are not allowed to heal enemies with healing effects.

RESHUFFLING/DEPLETING YOUR DECK

When your deck is empty, there will be circumstances that will trigger you to shuffle your discard pile and place it in your deck slot (a process known as reshuffling). **Whenever you do so, you must first advance your cube 1 space up the Corruption track on the corruption mat.**

Below are the conditions that cause you to reshuffle. Note again that all of these conditions assume your deck is empty.

- You are drawing cards during the Refresh Phase and need to draw more to fill to your hand size.
- A game effect causes you to draw some number of cards and you have more you need to draw.

• If you are in the Defend Phase, you can voluntarily reshuffle so you have the opportunity to defend with the top card of your deck (remember, your deck must be empty for you to be able to do this).

BEACONS AND SEARCH ACTIONS

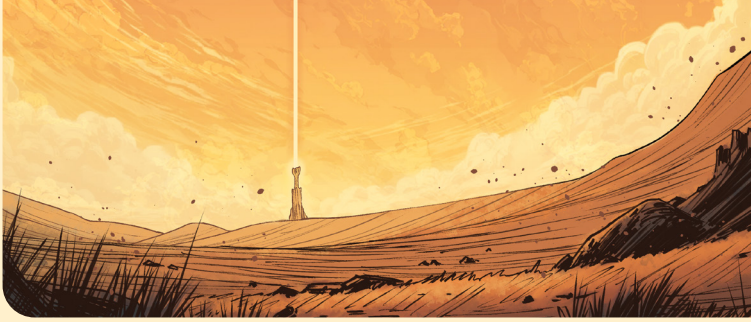
When you travel from location to location, you will have the opportunity to save beacons (see p.56). Beacons are location cards that you stack in a pile or column above your beacon mat and have various benefits and uses. When you spend or discard a beacon, it is discarded to the location discard pile.

Beacons are generally used for any of the following:

• **Search Actions** - You can take a search action once per location. You can search any time except during travel. To search, flip the beacon mat from its Ready side to its Exhausted side. Then, add a number of path tokens to the location card equal to the number of beacons you currently have. After you travel to a new location, the beacon mat will be flipped back to the Ready side, allowing you to Search again.

• **Discard for 2 Healing** - During the Refresh Phase, you will have the option to rest (see p.64). One way to rest is taking a Photonic Rest, which allows you to discard any number of your saved beacons, receiving 2 healing points per beacon discarded. **For every 1 beacon you discard for this purpose, you must add 1 obstacle token to the location.**

• **Discard for +2 Explore Booster** - Before calculating your total Explore Points (EP) during the Darkness Phase (see p.50), you have the option to discard any number of beacons to increase your Explore Booster by 2 for each beacon discarded. **You must also add 1 obstacle token to the active location card for each beacon you discard here.**



Other effects in the game may instruct you to discard or spend beacons. In these cases, you **do not** add obstacle tokens to the active location. You only add obstacle tokens when discarding beacons when used for Photonic Rest or as an Explore Booster.

When you spend or discard beacons for any reason, discard them to the location discard pile.

KEYWORDS

Keywords are shorthand for longer concepts you will find on some effects in the game.

Clone - Some effects may ask you to interact with clones of a card, such as the Mender profession's **Hidden Depth** skill. A clone is a virtual copy of the card being cloned. Clones are identical to the card being cloned, unless an effect says otherwise. Clones behave just like regular cards, except you cannot use effects to change anything about the card. For example, you could not use Temperance's **Resist** skill to increase the defense value of a clone created with Mender's **Hidden Depth** skill.

Clones disappear after resolving the effect that created them. For example, if you discard 3 clones as a result of Mender's **Hidden Depth** skill, those clones go away after you are done resolving **Hidden Depth**. You do not have to mentally track where clones are, what their stats are, etc., because clones are only around until the effect that created them is finished resolving.

(Your) Collection – This refers to any Radiance components you own but were not in the game at setup.

Cycle - Put the card on the bottom of the appropriate deck.

Disarm - Chosen enemy does not attack this round.

Discard - Put the component in question from in play to its designated discard area. For player cards, this means to the top of your discard pile. For locations, this means the location discard pile. For enemies, this means the appropriate enemy discard pile (Dusk vs. Doom). For tokens, this means back to the game's token supply.

If you discard a component that has cards attached to it or has tokens on it, generally the attached cards and tokens are discarded as well. The main exception to this occurs briefly during travel. You often need to keep some tokens around for a few steps just for reference as you set up your destination location (see p.59).

Echo - The top card of your discard pile. If you have no cards in your discard pile, you do not have an echo (see p.33).

Engage / Engaged With You - When an enemy moves from the quest area [Q] to your player area [P] in the Engagement Phase, it is said to have engaged you. Enemies in your player area [P] are engaged with you.

Mill - Move the required number of cards from the top of your deck to the top of your discard pile. If your deck runs out, reshuffle your discard to form a new deck (advancing corruption as normal - see p.37) and keep milling until you have milled the required amount of cards. Milling does not count as discarding cards.

Push - Move chosen enemy in your player area [P] to the quest area [Q]. Put the enemy to the front or back of the [Q] based on whether it is fast or slow, respectively.

Pull - Move chosen enemy from the quest area [Q] to your player area [P].

Recruit - Look at the 3 cards in the hobby market. Choose one card to add to your hand and one to cycle to the bottom of the hobby deck. Then, refill the hobby market to 3 cards.

Regenerate *X* - Move ***X*** cards from the **bottom** of your discard pile to the **bottom** of your deck.

Reveal / When Revealed - Revealing a card, typically enemies and treacheries, refers to flipping over the top card of the appropriate deck and placing it in its relevant position. A revealed treachery goes into the treachery column and becomes the active treachery. A revealed enemy is placed in the quest area [Q], either at the front or back of the line based on whether it is fast or slow, respectively. Relevant "When Revealed" effects resolve immediately after placing a revealed card.

Scout *X* - Look at the top ***X*** cards from the relevant deck and return them to the top in the same order. You can keep these cards face up so you don't have to remember what they are.

Tracked - Enemies are considered tracked when they have progress tokens on them equal to or greater than their darkness value.

Trapped - Enemies are considered trapped when there is a card with the ***trap*** trait attached to them.

Tranced - Enemies are considered tranced when there is a card with the ***trance*** trait attached to them.

Upon Arrival - Some locations have an "Upon Arrival" effect. Resolve these only once, immediately after resolving a travel in which this location was your chosen destination.

GAMEPLAY

OVERVIEW

A game of Radiance is played over a series of rounds, during which you will contend with the enemy and search for the source of the darkness - the Shade. Once found, you will enter a final encounter and battle until either you or the Shade is defeated.

WINNING AND LOSING

There is only one way to win: defeat the Shade! Each Shade card has text on the back explaining the rules for defeating them. This typically involves finding the Shade by traveling to one of its final locations, and then defeating the Shade while also exploring the final location (see p.66).

While there is only one way to victory, there are several ways a game can end in defeat. You lose the game immediately if any of the following happen:

- Your luminary has wounds equal to or in excess of their hit points (HP),
- You reach the corruption limit specified by the Shade's card,
- You reach the completed treachery limit specified by the Shade's card, or
- You do not have enough light ✸ to pay the cost of the 3 cheapest cards in your hand when playing cards in the Action Set Phase.

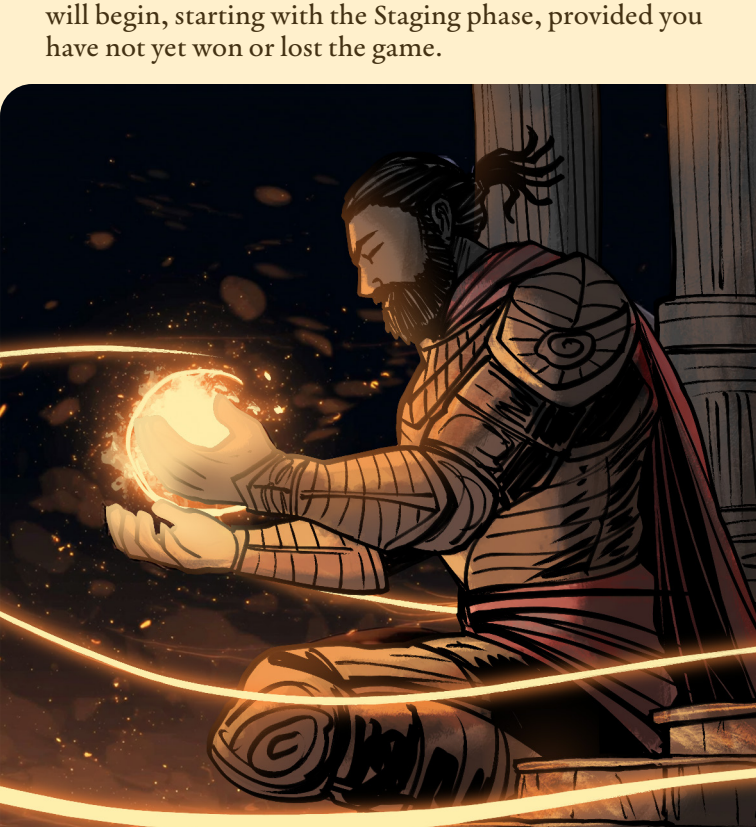
PLAYING A ROUND

Each round of Radiance is played in phases, where you will prepare your Luminary, see what the enemy is bringing against you this round, and contend with the ever-enclosing darkness. You will travel through the areas while also engaging the enemy in battle.

Each round has the following phases:

1. Staging phase (see p.44)
2. Action Set phase (see p.46)
3. Engagement phase (see p.48)
4. Darkness phase (see p.50)
5. Explore phase (see p.54)
6. Attack phase (see p.61)
7. Defend phase (see p.63)
8. Refresh phase (see p.64)

After completion of the Refresh phase, a new round will begin, starting with the Staging phase, provided you have not yet won or lost the game.



1. STAGING PHASE

During the staging phase, the enemy will prepare their forces and you will see what you will be contending with this round.

First, determine the value of your current **threat** ◔, which is equal to the sum of your current section on the threat track (the black bar corresponding to the current position of your cube on the track), plus the number of threat tokens on the current location card (if any).

Example: In this case, the cube is on space 3 of the threat track, which corresponds to a threat value of 4, as shown by the black bar above the cube. The location card has a single threat token on it, adding 1 to the threat. Therefore, the threat here would 5=4+1.

Then, reveal new enemies from the top of the Dusk and/or Doom decks until the sum of the darkness values on these revealed enemies is equal to or exceeds your calculated threat, following the below procedure:

- If you have 5 or more darkness left to reveal before reaching your current threat, reveal an enemy from the Doom deck. Otherwise, reveal an enemy from the Dusk deck.
- If the revealed enemy is fast, place the enemy at the right end of your quest area [Q], in front of any

enemies already in the Q. If the enemy is slow, place them at the left end of your Q, behind any enemies already in the Q.

• Subtract the darkness value of the placed card from the total darkness you need to reveal before reaching your threat level. If this value is 0 (or negative), move onto the next phase. Otherwise, add another enemy following this same procedure.

Example: Suppose you start with an empty quest area Q. As the threat calculated for this round is 5, you must reveal enemies until 5 or more darkness has been reached.

Since you are at the threshold of 5, the first enemy (1) must be revealed from the Doom deck and is placed in Q. This enemy has a darkness value of 3, meaning you have 2 more darkness to reveal, so now reveal from the Dusk deck.

The next enemy revealed (2) is a fast enemy with a darkness value of 1. The fast enemy is added to the right side of Q, ahead of the previous enemy. You have now revealed a total of 4 darkness, so must reveal another since your threat level is 5.

The next enemy revealed (3) is slow and has a darkness value of 2. It gets placed on the left side of the Q. You have now revealed 6 darkness, which exceeds 5, so you are done.

2. ACTION SET PHASE

In this phase, you will play 3 cards from your hand, each to a different area on your player board, also spending light equal to each card's cost. You will place one card for each of the following roles:

1. The Action card , placed to the left of your luminary mat,
2. The Attack card , placed at the bottom of your luminary mat, and
3. The Booster card & , placed to the right of your profession mat.

These 3 cards along with the Explore card (4) placed at the bottom of your profession mat (either during set up or during your previous turn) form your 4-card action set.

Example Action Set and player card layout

1. The action card provides an action that you can use during the turn, granting the printed effect(s), provided you meet the needed condition(s).

2. The attack card provides you with attack points used during the attack phase and also determines if your main attack this round is physical or photonic . In this case, it provides 7 attack points for a photonic attack.

3. The booster card both determines your active element this turn, which is used to determine which skills are active, and also provides additional values to both your attack points and explore points. Also, any permanent booster card with an element matching the active element provides its boost values to attack points and explore points. Here, the active element is fire, which also activates the first permanent booster as well, providing 2+3=5 extra attack points and 1+1=2 explore points.

To pay the light cost ✸ of your 3 played cards (not for the explore card, as you did not play that card this round), reduce your light ✸ by the sum of the played cards' costs. Reflect this by reducing the cube on your light track. If you cannot afford to pay the light cost of your chosen cards, you lose the game immediately, as your luminary does not have enough remaining light to use to fight or explore.

You must play all 3 cards each round. You cannot choose to forego placing any of these cards. Some effects will refer to cards or traits "in your action set" whereas some others refer to cards "in play." Your action set refers to these 4 cards described in this section, whereas "in play" includes the cards in your action set and, in addition, any card attached to an enemy or location.

4. The card played last round as the attack card (or placed during setup before round 1) is now used as the explore card, and it provides the printed value of explore points during the explore phase. The played card here provides 8 explore points.

Additionally, to play this action set, you will need to spend 5 light ✸ — 1 for the action card, 2 for the attack card and 2 for the booster card. You do not pay the light cost on the explore card.

3. ENGAGEMENT PHASE

During the engagement phase, the rightmost enemies currently in your quest area [Q] will move to your player area [P].

To determine how many enemies enter the player area [P], locate the yellow engagement section corresponding to your cube's location on the light track of your growth mat. The number next to the in that section indicates how many enemies from the right side of the quest area [Q] will enter the player area [P]. Move these enemies to the left of any enemies already in the [P].

Some engagement sections on your growth mat have additional icons next to them that must be resolved at this point. A / icon means you immediately reveal a dusk/doom enemy from the top of the corresponding deck and add it to the quest area [Q]. A icon means your luminary immediately takes the number of wounds written next to the icon.

Example: In this case, the cube is on space 13 of the light track, which corresponds to an engagement value of 2, as shown by the gold bar above the cube.

Q

P

The 2 rightmost enemies in the quest area now engage with you by entering the player area.

4. DARKNESS PHASE

In this phase, you will generate explore points (EP) and spend any or all of those to thwart the enemy darkness, with the remaining points going toward exploring this round.

This is done in 3 steps: 1. calculating EP, 2. allocating EP, and 3. resolution.

1. First calculate your total explore points (EP) by summing the value on your explore card ⓩ and the explore boost value on your booster card [ⓩ]. Also add the explore boost value [ⓩ] of any permanent booster cards [+] whose element matches the element of the booster card you played this turn.

Other effects, such as your action card's action, activated skills, or enemy abilities, may also increase or decrease your total EP.

Example: Here you have a total of 10 Explore points: 8 from your explore card, 1 from your played booster card, and 1 more from your permanent booster whose element matches your played booster card.

2. You must now choose how to allocate these points, using all points to either **cover the quest area darkness**, or **explore the current location**.

- Each enemy in the quest area Q has a darkness value ◈ on their card. You can allocate a number of EP from 0 up to the total of all darkness values ◈ on these cards in the Q.

For each darkness in the quest area Q not covered by spending EP, add a progress ‼ to the active treachery.

- Any remaining EP will be allocated to exploring the active location. All EP must be spent.

Example: As there is only 1 enemy left in the quest area and its darkness value is 2, you could allocate up to 2 EP to cover this darkness. All remaining EP will be applied as progress to explore your location.

Since the location requires exactly 10 additional progress to be fully explored (9 for its printed requirement and 1 additional from your cube's location on the resistance track), you could elect to not cover the darkness in the quest area to fully explore your location. This would result in 2 progress being added to the treachery.

TIP: *Place progress tokens next to the location card to help you remember the amount of EP devoted to exploring.*

3. Once all explore points have been allocated, if the amount of progress on the Treachery equals or exceeds its Progress Value (PV), the Treachery is complete. Proceed then to the **Completing Treacheries** section.

After completing the treachery (if necessary), if you attributed any EP toward exploring, move now to the Explore Phase. Otherwise that phase is skipped and you can proceed to the Attack Phase.

COMPLETING TREACHERIES

When the total progress 👣 on the treachery card equals or exceeds its progress value (PV) shown in the skull icon on the active treachery, the treachery is completed.

First, check to see if there are now a number of completed treacheries equal to the Shade's completed treacheries limit. If so, you immediately lose the game as the Shade has advanced their evil agenda so far that you could not possibly stop it.

Otherwise, complete the following steps:

1. Resolve the treachery's **When Completed** effect.
2. Remove progress from the treachery equal to its PV.
3. Draw a new treachery card from the treachery deck and place it on top of the completed treachery. Overlap this new active treachery with all completed treacheries so that the legacy effects (the box on the bottom half of the card) of all completed treacheries are still visible. Legacy effects of **completed** treacheries are in play for the rest of the game!

Note: The legacy effect of the active treachery is not in play until that treachery is completed.

4. Transfer any progress 👣 remaining on the completed treachery to the new active treachery. Surplus progress on a completed treachery carries over to the new treachery, so don't be careless with

letting too much progress through to the treachery!

Example: If we did indeed choose to apply all 10 EP to exploring, 2 progress would be added to the treachery. In the pictured case, this would bring the progress on the active treachery to 8, which exceeds the PV of 7, thus completing this treachery. This is the first treachery completed, so we have not met the 3 treachery limit of the Pride Shade.

The ***when completed*** *effect of the treachery,* **Reinforcements**, *adds one extra threat token to the current location, bringing the total to 2 threat on the location.*

A new treachery, **Sabotage**, *is then drawn and placed overlapping the previous treachery so that the legacy effect is visible, and the excess 1 progress is now added to this treachery. From now on, it will cost one additional light to play a card with the earth element into your action set!*

Note*: Pay close attention to all effects in play. The current location as shown in the previous example has an effect that causes you to take 2 wounds when this treachery was completed!*

5. EXPLORE PHASE

During the explore phase, you must spend any remaining explore points (EP) to place progress on your current location, and eventually travel to the next. If you do not have any explore points (EP) remaining after resolving the Darkness Phase, skip the Explore Phase.

Otherwise, for each EP left, add a progress to the location using progress tokens from the supply.

To fully explore a location, you must have a number of progress tokens on it matching the location's explore value (EV). The explore value (EV) is given by the sum of the **printed explore value** on the card and the **value corresponding to the space on the resistance track** where your cube is currently located.

If the amount of progress on the location is less than the location's EV, proceed now to the Attack phase.

If progress on the location equals or exceeds the location's EV, the location is considered explored and you must move on. Gain the XP reward noted on the location by taking XP tokens from the supply. Then, immediately travel, as explained next.

Example: During the darkness phase, you had 10 leftover EP, which now causes 10 progress to be placed on the location card. This fully explores the location, as it needed 9 progress from the card and 1 from your cube's placement on the resistance track. Proceed now to travel!

Note: You cannot use card actions or skills after exploring a location but before traveling; you must proceed directly to travel.

Note: Unlike treacheries, surplus progress placed on a location does not carry over to the next location.

TRAVEL

Once a location is fully explored, you must travel to a new location. Traveling can be very impactful on various parts of the game and is how you will eventually track down the Shade. Traveling greater distances causes you to draw more attention to yourself, increasing the severity of threats you face in future rounds.

To travel to a new location, complete the following steps:

1. Choose a new destination

2. Resolve the distance traveled

3. Arrive at the destination

4. Reduce Shade influence

1. **Choose a destination**: There are three possible ways to choose your next destination.

   a. Use your Fetch Action (can be used only once per game) - Taking a fetch action allows you to find and immediately travel to any location of your choice from the location deck. To take a fetch action, the New Location token must be showing the side that says "Fetch: Ready", and is then immediately flipped to the "Fetch: Exhausted" side. The location you just finished exploring must also have coordinates that sum to 6 or greater (e.g. a (2,4) coordinate location would qualify!). If you meet these conditions, pay 4 XP, then search the location deck for any location in it. Immediately choose this as your destination and travel to it.

You do not have the opportunity to save beacons or defer locations. You do, however, still need to abide by the effects of any paths and obstacles that were at the explored location, as will be described in the resolving distance step.

b. Travel to a Beacon - Provided you have a saved beacon, you can choose to travel to that location now.

c. Seek a Destination - Reveal cards from the top of the location deck in search of your next destination. Reveal cards one at a time. After each card you reveal, choose one of the following:

   i. Travel to the location - Place the revealed card as your new location and proceed to the resolve distance step.

   ii. Save the Location as a Beacon - Place the revealed card above your beacon mat, saving the location as a beacon. You may only choose this option if you have beacon capacity remaining,

Example: You must now pick a new location to travel to. Since the ***New Location token*** *is still on its front side, you do have the option to fetch a location, though you elect not to, as you don't want to spend the 4XP.*

You also have 4 beacons available to which you could travel, but the closest one is still at least 3 distance away, and you would like to save beacons for future use.

You therefore decide to seek a destination. You draw the first card off the top of the location deck and reveal (1) **Pit of Shada**, *which is quite far away. You elect to save it as a beacon, which now puts you at your beacon capacity as Courage has a beacon capacity of 5.*

You seek again, this time revealing (2) **Terrimor**, *which you*

meaning that you do not have beacons already saved equal to your beacon capacity, as printed on your luminary mat (A).

iii. Defer the Location - Place the location on the table temporarily below your current location. This is your deferred locations area, and these locations will be cycled (moved to the bottom of the location deck) in the next step of travel. Deferred locations do not count against your beacon capacity, but each deferred location adds 1 distance to your travel. There is no limit to how many locations you can defer in a given travel.

iv. Emergency Beacon Travel - Choose to either save the revealed location as a beacon or defer it. Then, choose to either pay 3 XP or advance the threat cube 2 spaces (if you do not have 3 XP to pay, you must advance the threat cube). Finally, choose one of your saved beacons as your destination location and proceed to the Resolve Distance step.

decide to defer in hopes of a better option, placing it below the location deck.

Finally, you seek again and reveal (3) **Thretin**, *choosing it as your new destination.*

You could have also used an Emergency Beacon for travel and maybe would have if this last location wasn't satisfactory.

2. **Resolve Distance**: You now evaluate the distance you needed to travel to arrive at your new location and resolve what the enemy accomplished as you traveled. To do so, follow these steps in order:

   a. Calculate the distance traveled by summing the following:

      i. *Geographic distance* - Compare the coordinates of your current location to those of the destination. Find the difference between the East coordinates of each, and add to that value the difference between the South coordinates.

      ii. *Terrain modifier* - Every obstacle token on the current location adds +1 to the distance, and every path token subtracts 1.

      iii. *Deferred locations* - Each location deferred while seeking a destination (see step 1.c.iii) adds +1 distance to the total.

Example: In this case, you are moving from location (3,2) to (2,4), so you are moving 1 distance Eastward and 2 distance Southward for a total of 3 geographic distance.

The single path token on the location reduces distance by 1.

Finally, since you deferred a single location, distance is increased by 1, so the total travel distance is 3-1+1=3.

You move your cube 3 spaces forward on the distance track, which shows that you must move your cubes 2 spaces up the threat track and 3 up the resistance track. You then return your distance cube to its initial position.

b. Advance Threat and Resistance - Advance the cube on the Distance Track on the corruption mat a number of spaces equal to your travel distance calculated in the last step. Advance the cubes on the Threat Track and the Resistance Track the number of spaces shown on the space the cube now occupies. Finally, reset the distance track cube by putting it on the space below the cube marking Corruption.

Note: If you have reached the rightmost space on the Distance Track and still need to move the cube further for your traveled distance, add 2 threat tokens to the destination location for every additional distance you must still travel (or add 3 threat tokens instead if using the Hard side of the mat). There is a visual reminder of this below the rightmost space on the Distance Track .

3. **Arrive at Destination:** You now arrive at the selected destination card, resolving the following steps in order:

   a. Discard all threat tokens and progress tokens on the explored location. Discard the explored location into the location discard pile located above the Shade Influence mat. Put the destination location in the active location space with the New Location Token on top of it.

   b. For every 2 path tokens that were on the previous location, add 1 threat token to the new location, as following a beaten path made your travel more conspicuous to the enemy. Discard all path and obstacle tokens.

   c. Flip the beacon mat to the side that says "Ready," making the search action again available.

   d. Cycle any locations deferred during travel, placing them at the bottom of the location deck.

4. **Advance Shade Influence Track** - As you explore locations, you are reducing the Shade's influence on the surrounding areas. To represent this, move the cube on the Shade Influence track 1 space forward.

Example: After discarding the previous location, no threat tokens are added, as there was only a single path token on the location. **Terrimor** *is returned to the bottom of the deck, and the beacon mat would be flipped back to its Ready side if necessary.*

The cube on the Shade Influence mat advances one space.

Finally, both the old and new location have effects that need to be resolved, adding tokens to the new location and also reducing your light by one, as one ***Thretin*** *enemy is in play. The* ***New Location token*** *is also placed on the location.*

Note: The Shade Influence track is also the most reliable way to track how many locations you have explored, as the location discard pile will sometimes be manipulated by other game effects.

AD HOC TRAVEL: On occasion, there may be times outside of the travel phase where you add progress tokens to the location. If at any point a location is fully explored by your placement of progress tokens, resolve travel immediately as described above, then return to your place in the round flow after completing travel.

6. ATTACK PHASE

You now contend with the enemies in your player area [P] by first attacking and then defending against any remaining enemies in the next phase.

To attack the enemies, follow these steps in order.

1. Calculate your total **attack points (AP)** by summing the following:
   i. the attack value on your attack card,
   ii. the attack boost value on your booster card [],
   iii. the attack boost value on any active permanent booster cards [+], meaning cards that share the same element as your booster card played this round, and
   iv. any additional attack or booster from actions and/or skills played.

Note: It can be helpful to track your AP using the AP tracker provided in the deluxe edition or alternatively via any type of counter or token.

Example: Your selected attack card provides a photonic attack of strength 7. Your played booster card gives a bonus 3 to this attack, and your permanent booster with the fire element is also active (as it matches your played booster's element) providing another 2 attack. You therefore have a main photonic attack of 7+3+2=12 AP.

You do not have any active skills that boost this attack.

2. Select **any** enemy in your player area [P] and resolve an attack against them as follows:

   i. Choose how many AP to apply to that enemy, reducing your pool of AP available by that amount.

   ii. If the enemy's defense type matches the type on your attack card (physical ⚔ or photonic ✦), the enemy blocks as many AP as their defense value. Attacks of the other type go through undefended.

   iii. Add a number of wound tokens ♥ equal to the number of unblocked AP to the selected enemy. If the enemy has taken a number of wounds equal to its HP value, the enemy is defeated. Discard the enemy card and gain XP tokens equal to the XP reward value of the card. Resolve any **when defeated** effects printed on the card.

3. Repeat step 2, selecting new enemies until you have spent all AP or choose to no longer attack.

Note: You can choose to not apply all the AP you have available. Leftover AP does not carry over to the next round.

Proceed now to the Defend Phase.

Example: You generated 12 AP for a photonic attack and can now apply that to the enemies.

Since the **Theretin Hillman** *has physical defense, your photonic attack ignores their defense. You defeat this enemy by expending 8 AP. You gain 3 XP and discard* **Theretin Hillman**.

You are left with 4AP, and unfortunately, the **Garadeth Seeker** *enemy has 3 photonic defense and 2 HP. With 4 AP, they will defend against 3 of it and only take a single wound.*

7. DEFEND PHASE

Any remaining enemies in your player area [P] will now attack you. Each enemy has an attack value and an attack type (either physical or photonic — the same as their defense type shown on the card). Resolve each enemy's attack separately in the order of your choosing following these steps:

1. **Defend (optional)** - You may discard any number of cards from your hand and/or the top of your deck whose defense type (/) matches the enemy's attack type, reducing the incoming damage by the sum of the discarded cards' defense values . An enemy's attack cannot be reduced below 0, and surplus defense is lost after defending **each attack**.

Note*:* You can discard multiple cards from the top of the deck, so long as their defense type matches that of the incoming attack. If your deck is empty, you can choose to reshuffle your deck to continue to try defending with the top card, following the usual procedure of reshuffling your deck (see p.37).

2. **Incur wounds** - Any unblocked attack damage is then taken as wounds by placing a number of wound tokens on your luminary mat equal to the remaining unblocked attack. **If your luminary ever has wounds equal to or exceeding their HP value, you are defeated and lose the game immediately!**

Repeat this process until all enemies in your player area [P] have resolved their attack.

Example: The only enemy remaining has an attack value of 1 and a photonic defense and attack.

It also has an effect causing it to attack twice since your corruption is at 4, so you suffer 2 attacks, both of strength 1.

Example: You are on the recieving end of 2 photonic attacks of strength 1 each. If you elect to defend, you must defend with a photonic card, so the top card of your deck cannot be used, nor can the **Ever Onward** *card in hand as they are physical cards, but you could use any of the other cards in hand.*

Since you are receiving 2 separate attacks, you must suffer each individually. You, for example, could ***not*** *use* **Striking Gold**, *which provides 2 photonic defense, to defend both attacks with a single card. Instead, you could defend with 2 cards, discarding both, or elect to take wounds instead for one or both attacks to discard fewer cards.*

8. REFRESH PHASE

You now resolve the following steps in preparation for the next round.

1. Update the Location - If the location has the **New Location** token on it, move the token to the top of the location deck. Otherwise, add 1 threat token to the location.
2. Produce Light - Move your cube up the light track on your growth mat equal to the highest light production level you've unlocked on the character growth track (shown as ***X***).
3. Rest (optional) There are two ways to rest, and you may choose to rest in both, one or neither way.
   i. **Physical Rest:** Pay 3 XP and heal (remove wounds) equal to the highest Rest level you've

unlocked on the character growth track (shown as (X).

ii. **Photonic Rest:** Discard any number of beacons, healing 2 (removing 2 wounds) per beacon discarded, also adding 1 obstacle token per beacon discarded in this way.

4. Discard and Shift - Discard your Action card , Booster card / , and Explore card , placing them in the discard pile in any order of your choosing. Then shift your Attack card to the Explore slot to be used as your Explore card next round. **You may then optionally discard any additional cards from hand. (This must be done after discarding/shifting the action set.)**

Note: At this point, skills are no longer considered active for the round because your booster has been discarded, so be sure to use any skills before discarding!

5. Draw Cards - Draw cards from your deck into your hand until you reach your hand size , which is the highest indicated value (X) unlocked above the character growth track . If you run out of cards in your deck and need to draw more, shuffle your discard pile (ensuring you don't flip any cards over) and return it to your deck space to replenish your deck, advancing 1 space up the Corruption Track , as previously described (see p.37).

6. Ready Companion - If you are playing with a companion and they are exhausted, ready them by rotating the card upright.

After completing these steps, start the next round with the Staging Phase.

If you are at a final location and meet the conditions noted on the Shade's card, proceed to the Shade Encounter (see p.66).

SHADE ENCOUNTER

SHADE CARDS

Each Shade card has 2 sides and begins the game flipped to its back side that is full of text. This text has the rules for how you will interact with the Shade this game, including:

1. The Shade's **Final Locations,** which are the locations the Shade can be revealed in, including the coordinates of these locations.
2. Any special rules, such as how and when the Shade is revealed, or special effects in play during the Shade encounter.
3. The conditions that must be met for victory.
4. The Shade's loss conditions. If you reach the shown corruption limit or completed treachery limit, you lose the game immediately.

When you begin the Shade encounter, the Shade card is flipped to its front side, which depicts the Shade and has its stats and abilities.

Once revealed in this way, Shades behave like any other enemy and you can affect Shades with any effect that can be applied to enemies.

Example: This Shade, Pride, will be revealed when you travel to Molta - location (6,5), or when one of the other conditions (1) are met. At that point, the card is flipped to its front, showing the stats and abilities of Pride that are in effect during the Shade encounter.

SHADE REVEAL AND SHADE INFLUENCE

By default, you reveal the Shade at the end of the next Staging Phase after traveling to a final location. Some Shades break this rule, but these instances are printed on the Shade's card reverse side as special rules.

In the round the Shade will be revealed, you must resolve the Shade Influence modifier found on the Shade Influence mat. The more locations that you explore, the further along this track you will move, weakening the Shade's effect and possibly even giving yourself a bonus.

To resolve the Shade Influence modifier, consult the space in which your cube is located on the Shade Influence mat and resolve the icon above that space, if any is there.

- If there is a "*+X* ◑" above the space, for this round only, your threat ◑ is increased by this value. Therefore, during the Staging Phase when you are revealing enemies, you will be adding more or stronger enemies to the quest area [Q]. The effect is no longer active on any subsequent rounds - only the round in which the Shade is revealed.
- If there is a "*+X* ✪" above the space , you immediately gain that much XP ✪ and can spend it as usual.
- If there is no icon, there is no added effect.

WINNING THE GAME

After resolving the Shade Influence modifier and completing the Staging Phase, the Shade will enter play as an enemy, and this begins the **Shade Encounter.**

To win the game, you must do all of the following:

- Defeat the Shade by inflicting a number of wounds equal to or exceeding the Shade's HP,

- Explore the **Final Location** where you are currently located, and
- Survive to the end of the round after both above conditions are completed.

Shades may also stipulate additional requirements to win or may modify the Shade encounter in some way. Refer to the back of the Shade's card for the specifics.

Note: you do not need to defeat the Shade and explore the final location in the same turn or in a specific order.

When you defeat the Shade, remove its card from the game and continue playing until you have met all other victory conditions, including exploring the Final Location.

Example: During the staging phase, you will gain an extra 2XP since you have explored 6 locations and have advanced quite far on the Shade Influence mat.

Also during the staging phase of the round after you travelled to **Molka**, *you do not need to add any additional threat from the Shade Influence mat, which you would have had you only explored 1 or 2 locations before your final travel.*

In the case here, you will need to reveal 6+1=7 (6 for the threat track and 1 for the threat token on **Molka***) darkness worth of enemies, and after doing so, Pride will also enter the quest area at the left side of the queue as Pride is a slow enemy.*

THE FINAL LOCATION

The final location behaves similarly to all locations you visit throughout the game, with a few minor changes.

- To explore the Final Location, you must place enough progress tokens on it to equal or exceed its Explore Value EV (including its printed value and any additional progress required based on your position on the progress track on the corruption mat). **In addition to this,** each obstacle token on the final location increases the EV by 1, requiring 1 additional progress token.
- Once explored, you do not leave the Final Location. Instead, rotate the card 90 degrees to exhaust it. You do not gain any XP when this location is explored. You can continue to place progress tokens on the Final Location after it has been exhausted.
- If at any point, the EV of the card exceeds the amount of progress tokens on the card (either by losing progress or its EV increasing), the Final Location is unexhausted and additional progress tokens must be added until you meet or exceed this new required value.

NOTE: When exhausted, location effects are still in play.

- The final location can accumulate threat tokens even after it is explored, including during the Refresh Phase of every completed round.

Example: After 2 rounds, Molta has been fully explored with 18 progress tokens (11+6+1: 11 for the card, 6 from the resistance track, +1 for the obstacle). Do not gain XP or travel!

ADJUSTING THE DIFFICULTY

Radiance uses a customizable difficulty system. You can use one of the pre-configured difficulty settings provided for convenience listed below.

Or, you can learn how to customize your difficulty with the difficulty rating system (see p.73), in which you select items from a "menu" of options to make your game easier, harder, or a mix of both! This way, you can tailor the game to your taste or feeling of the day.

PRECONFIGURED DIFFICULTY SETTINGS

For those new to the game, or those not interested in customizing their own difficulty, we have provided a list of 6 pre-configured difficulty settings below. You will find the difficulty setting's name, instructions, and description.

There is also a difficulty rating listed beside the setting's name for reference. This value gives you context of how challenging of a game to expect. To learn more about difficulty ratings, see the custom difficulty setting section (p73).

Note: If you want to play with a Shadow (see p.78), you will need to customize your own difficulty setting.

Below are the 6 pre-configured difficulty setting options, listed from easiest (Ember) to hardest (High Radiance). Use the normal setup process (see p.10), but change your setup based on the instructions listed under your chosen difficulty setting.

EMBER (DIFFICULTY RATING: 5)

This provides an easier, less stressful game. Ideal for new players or players who want a more casual experience.

Setup instructions:

- Play with both track mats on the normal difficulty

sides,

- Use a 3-strength companion (see p.76), and
- Give yourself 6 XP during setup.

SPARK (DIFFICULTY RATING: 7)

This provides an easier-than-average game, but still offers a good challenge. It is especially useful when trying out new builds or strategies.

Setup instructions:

- Play with both track mats on the normal difficulty sides,
- Use a 2-strength companion (see p.76), and
- Give yourself 3 XP during setup.

FLAME (DIFFICULTY RATING: 9)

This provides a slightly easier-than-average game. Many players will find this is their preferred setting, even after they are experienced with playing Radiance.

Setup instructions:

- Play with both tracks mats on their normal difficulty sides, and
- Use a 1-strength companion (see p.76).

BLAZE (DIFFICULTY RATING: 10)

The Blaze difficulty setting is considered the standard game difficulty, but don't expect it to be easy, especially when you're new to the game. It is still intended to be challenging, even for experienced players.

Setup instructions:

- Play with both tracks mats on their normal difficulty sides, and
- Play without a companion.

RADIANT (DIFFICULTY RATING: 13)

Radiant difficulty is intended to provide an extremely challenging game. It is recommended only for very experienced players of Radiance. Radiant difficulty is meant to be a crowning achievement for a player — you are considered to be among the brightest luminaries to ever protect Farhome if you can win on this difficulty.

Setup instructions:

- Flip both track mats to their hard difficulty sides,
- Flip the Shade Influence mat to its hard side, and
- Play without a companion.

HIGH RADIANCE (DIFFICULTY RATING: 16)

The High Radiance difficulty setting is meant for extremely experienced and highly skilled Radiance players in search of a very challenging game. If you manage to win on this difficulty, you are among the rare and elite group of luminaries to ever achieve the rank of High Radiance.

Setup instructions:

- Flip both tracks mats to their hard difficulty sides,
- Flip the Shade Influence mat to its hard side,
- Advance the cube on the corruption track 1 space,
- Advance the cube on the threat track 1 space,
- Advance the cube on the resistance track 5 spaces, and
- Play without a companion.

CUSTOMIZING DIFFICULTY

Once you are familiar with the game, try creating your own customized difficulty setting. You choose from a "menu" of a la carte options that increase or decrease the difficulty rating. The default difficulty rating is 10, which corresponds to the pre-configured Blaze difficulty setting found in the previous section (see p.71).

You can mix and match by selecting any combination of the options listed below. Then, based on your selections, subtract from or add to the default rating of 10 to calculate your game's custom difficulty rating. To get an idea of how challenging your difficulty rating is, check it against the difficulty ratings noted with the pre-configured difficulty settings in the previous section. You can read the descriptions of the pre-configured settings to gauge how challenging you can expect your custom game to be.

To create your custom difficulty, begin with all the default settings. This means:

- The tracks mats and Shade Influence mat are on their Normal difficulty sides,
- You do not have a companion (see p.76) or a Shadow (see p.78), and
- The cubes on the corruption, threat and resistance tracks begin on the left-most spaces of those tracks.

Then, select any number of the options listed below, increasing or decreasing from the default difficulty rating of 10 based on your selections. The rating adjustment is listed in parenthesis (+/- ***X***).

- **BRING A COMPANION (- *X*, where *X* is companion strength)**

Select one of the 8 companions (see p.76) to bring along on your adventure. Subtract its strength value

(1, 2, or 3, as noted on the companion card) from your difficulty rating. You can select up to 3 companions, but we recommend only bringing 1 (or at most 2) companion(s). Too many companions can take the focus away from the main puzzle of interacting with your player cards, skills and actions. The optimal Radiance experience tends to be with fewer companions for that reason. (You can always choose a single strength 3 companion if you want a powerful ally!)

- **START WITH 3 or 6 XP AT SETUP (- 1 or -2)**
- **INCLUDE A SHADOW (+*X*, where *X* is the Shadow's strength.)**

You may include one or more Shadows in the game (see p.78). Add the Shadow's strength value to your difficulty rating (3, 4, or 6, as noted on the back side of the Shadow card). Shadows greatly increase the difficulty of a game, so we recommend only bringing one. But there is nothing stopping you from bringing all 4 Shadows into a single game.

- **FLIP ALL MATS TO THEIR HARD SIDE (+3)**

Flip the corruption, growth, and Shade Influence mats to their Hard sides during setup.

- **ADVANCE CUBES (+3)**

During setup, advance the cube on the corruption track 1 space, advance the cube on the threat track 1 space and advance the cube on the resistance track 5 spaces.

- **MANDATORY SIDE QUESTS (+1)**

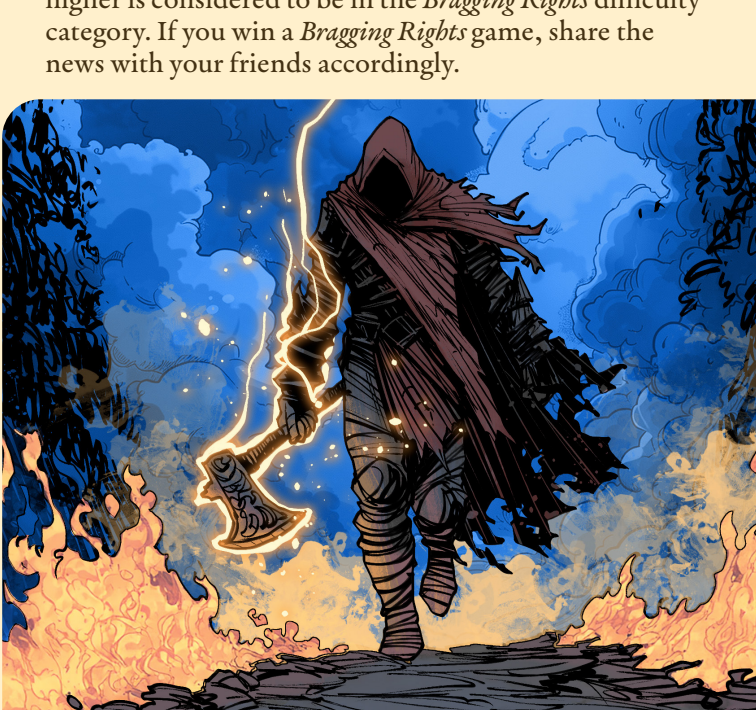
This setting requires you to play with the optional Side Quests module (see p.82). Normally, gaining and completing side quests is voluntary. If you play using the Mandatory Side Quests option, you are required to complete at least 2 side quests in your game, or you lose.

- **MANDATORY LOCATION BARON (+2)**

This setting requires you to play with the optional Location Barons module (see p.87). The default way to play with this module is that you are not required to defeat any Location Barons (this is difficulty neutral). The Mandatory Location Baron difficulty setting requires you to defeat at least 1 Location Baron before the end of the game, or you lose. This applies whether you are playing the Random Encounters or Quest Encounter setup.

How Difficult is My Game?

The easiest possible configuration is a difficulty rating of 0, and the hardest possible difficulty rating is 36. A difficulty rating of 10 is considered an average difficulty game, though this should still be considered quite challenging! Any custom difficulty setting of rating 20 or higher is considered to be in the *Bragging Rights* difficulty category. If you win a *Bragging Rights* game, share the news with your friends accordingly.



COMPANIONS

With this addition to the game, you have an ally fighting by your side. Each companion has a strength value used in determining the challenge level of your game (pictured at location (7) on the card to the right), along with various other effects.

To play with a companion, during setup, place your chosen companion on the table with their basic side face up.

During the round, you may **exhaust a ready companion for one of several uses.** Exhausting your companion means rotating it 90 degrees to the right. A companion can be exhausted to do any of the following:

1. Add their Explore value (1) to your Explore card's Explore value in the Action Set Phase. This is treated as an increase to your Explore card's explore value.

2. Attack 1 enemy in your player area [P] in the Attack Phase using your companion's printed attack value and type (2). Your companion attacks alone; you cannot combine your attack points with theirs. Enemies will use their defense against your companion if their defense type matches your companion's attack type.

3. Defend an enemy attack in the Defend Phase. They become the only target of this attack, and you cannot split the defense or damage between a companion and your luminary. Your companion applies their defense stat (3) to the enemy's attack, provided their defense type matches the enemy's attack type (/), and then takes any surplus attack points as wounds. If your companion ever takes wounds equal to or exceeding their HP (4), they are defeated and you remove them from the game.

4. Use your companion's exhaust ability , if they have one (5). You can only use this ability once per

round, and exhaust your companion to use it.

Each round during the Refresh Phase, your companion readies. This means their card is rotated upright if it had been exhausted.

Some companions have passive abilities ∞ (5) which work as any other passive effect (see p.26). These abilities are ongoing and always in play so long as your companion is in play, **even if they are exhausted.**

Some companions may also have a destroy ability (6). After resolving a destroy ability, your companion is defeated and is removed from the game. You can use a destroy ability even if your companion is exhausted.

Companions on their basic side have a flip condition (5). The moment the flip condition is met, flip your companion to their advanced side. They remain on their advanced side for the rest of the game. If they were exhausted when you flipped them, they remain exhausted after flipping them.

SHADOWS

Shadows are an optional way to increase the difficulty of your game. Each Shadow played increases the difficulty by their difficulty value pictured at (4). There are 4 Shadow cards provided. Each Shadow has a Shade counterpart, which shares a distinguishing icon with the Shade, pictured at (5) in the example. If you play with 1 or more Shadows in your game, you are **not** required to defeat the Shadows to win.

THEME

Thematically, if playing with the Shadow that corresponds to your chosen Shade, the Shadow represents the Shade taking a more active role in trying to stop your quest in the early stages. Defeating the Shadow then represents thwarting these early attempts, beating them in an early altercation. They will still come back with a vengeance during the Shade Encounter!

When playing with Shadows differing from your chosen Shade, the Shadows represent a Shade with lesser influence in the region and who knows you aren't coming for them just yet. Shades - being selfish creatures only tied together under a tenuous alliance - won't go out of their way to help the other Shades as it's just not worth the risk. But that doesn't mean they aren't perfectly willing to be a thorn in your side if they are in the neighborhood.

GAMEPLAY WITH A SHADOW

Here, we'll describe a game as if you are playing against a single Shadow, but you are welcome to play against more than one for an extra challenge!

During setup, place the chosen Shadow card to the left of the enemy decks and Shade card with its "meddler" side faceup. The space the Shadow card occupies is considered the **meddler area.**

On its "meddler" side, the Shadow has a **Meddle** effect (1) that is in play that you must contend with during the round.

Additionally, the Shadow has **intervene** text (2). Once the condition of this text is met, the Shadow card is flipped to its other side and will enter play as an enemy at the end of the next Staging Phase.

Note: If the Shadow and Shade are revealed in the same round, reveal the Shadow before the Shade.

Once it is in play in the quest area Q or your player area P, the Shadow behaves just like an enemy. You can defeat the Shadow like normal enemies. When the Shadow is defeated, gain their XP reward and remove them from the game.

The Shadow may have special rules dictating how they act or what extra effects may be in play (3). Be sure to read the Shadow's text box carefully and follow any special instructions it provides.

ADDITIONAL MODES OF PLAY

There are 4 optional modules you can choose to add to your game. Two of the modules, Side Quests and Location Barons, are systems you can add to the game for more variety and complexity. The Limited Quest module provides special quests specific to each Luminary and Profession, and adds a system of meta progression to the game. The final module, Twin Flames, is a way to play the game cooperatively with two players.

You are free to play with all, some, or none of the optional modules in your game. They are compatible with each other, so feel free to mix and match. We recommend not adding these modules until you have played a few games and are more comfortable with understanding the rules and general strategies of Radiance.

Additionally provided here is an alternative mode of play called Blitz mode. Blitz gives you a way to play a quicker but still challenging game that gives the feel of a full game.

Blitz mode can be played with any of the above modules with the exception of the Limited Quests. We recommend that the Limited Quests only be completed when playing the full game.

BLITZ

Blitz Mode is designed to give you a faster way to play Radiance while still providing a satisfying game that still has a complete arc. It is intended to provide as much of a challenge as a normal game of Radiance, so experienced players should not shy away from playing Blitz games when pressed for time.

To play Blitz Mode, make the following modifications to the normal rules.

- Do not select a Shade for your game. Instead, choose

1 Shadow to be your final opponent. When you have defeated the Shadow and explored the final location (similar to a normal game), you win the game! If you survive the rest of that round, that is.

• Mechanically, the Shadow works exactly the same as Shadows do in a normal game. It starts the game on its Meddler side at setup and its Meddle effects are in play from the start. It will also Intervene at the appropriate time based on its Intervene condition.

• You will have a Corruption limit and Completed Treachery limit just as in normal games of Radiance. To find these limits, look at the limits printed on the Shade card that corresponds to your chosen Shadow, as listed below. The Corruption and Treachery limits for your game are equal to half the limits of the corresponding Shade, rounded up.

Greed > Greedling	Pride > Vanity Wisps
Envy > Covetous Flail	Wrath > Raveger

• The effects of the Shade Influence mat upon the Shadow being revealed are half the printed values, rounded up.

• Whatever location you are in when the Shadow comes into play is considered the final location for the game. This follows the same rules as the final location in a normal game. You must fully explore it to win, but you do not travel when you explore it (rotate it 90 degrees instead).

• In addition to the normal rules for Fetch actions, you are only allowed to take a Fetch action if you have explored at least 3 locations.

• If you choose the **Ravager** Shadow, it does not respawn after you defeat it once.

SIDE QUESTS

Created by Ivan Lo

The Side Quests module is a way to increase variability and make games feel even more dynamic. You can add side quests into any game.

The Side Quests module introduces the Quest Board, which has requests for help, opportunities for brave adventurers, and even contracts for those in need of heroic deeds. You can choose to devote resources in the form of explore points (EP) and XP to take on these quests. Once you have accepted a quest, it is up to you as to how and when (if at all) to complete the quest. A quest is completed as soon as you meet its objective (1) and you immediately gain its reward (2), which can then be used in your journey and battle against the Shade.

ADDITIONAL COMPONENTS

37 Side Quest cards

1 Modules Reference Card

1 Quest Board mat

SETUP

1. Set the Quest Board mat onto the same difficulty (Normal or Hard side) as the corruption, growth, and Shade Influence mats.
2. Shuffle the Quest cards into a face-down stack to form the Quest deck. Place the Quest deck near the Quest Board mat.

3. Place a cube on the "0" space of the Quest Board mat.

4. Reveal 5 Quest cards, face-up, placing them above the Quest Board mat. These represent quests posted on the quest board available for taking.

5. You may optionally cycle any number of these 5 revealed quests to the bottom of the deck, refilling to 5 cards from the top of the Quest deck.

6. If there are multiple face-up Special Victory Condition quests, choose one. Cycle all other Special Victory Condition quests and re-reveal back up to 5 face-up quests. Repeat this process as needed until your chosen Special Victory Condition quest is the only face-up Special Victory Condition quest.

GENERAL RULES

- You begin the game with no active quests.
- The 5 revealed quests represent quests that are posted on the quest board, available to you throughout your journey in the game.
- The quest board does not refill; the quests revealed during setup are the only quests that are available for undertaking during the game.

- At any time, you may accept a quest by paying the stated cost in the next space on the Quest Board mat and advancing the cube. The chosen quest is now an active and ongoing quest that you can complete.
- There is no limit to how many active quests you may have simultaneously. There is no limit to how many quests can be completed in a single turn unless stated otherwise.
- Once a quest objective is met, that quest is completed and you immediately gain its reward.
- For compact display of acquired quest rewards, tuck all obtained rewards under any acquired permanent boosters.
- Quest rewards are treated as regular player skills or card action effects (see p.26).
- If a reward has a icon, this means that the quest card is returned to the bottom of the Quest deck after its first use.
- A Special Victory Condition quest must be undertaken before you begin the Shade Encounter.

VOLUNTARY VS. MANDATORY SIDE QUESTS

There are two ways to include side quests in your game: voluntary or mandatory. Voluntary quests do not change the difficulty rating of your game, but Mandatory quests make your game more difficult (see p.73).

- Voluntary Side Quests (+0): You can choose to interact with the side quests as much or as little as you like during your game.
- Mandatory Side Quests (+1): You are required to complete **at least 2** Side Quests before the game ends. If you complete fewer than 2, you lose.

LIMITED QUESTS

Created by Ivan Lo

Limited Quests are special quests unique to each Luminary and Profession (there are 8 in total). Limited Quests are a way to unlock meta progression in the game. That is, once you beat the quest, its reward is unlocked permanently and can be brought into nearly all future games that use that character.

The only exception is that you are not allowed to bring any previously-unlocked limited quest rewards into games where you are playing with a not-yet-beaten limited quest.

GAMEPLAY

To play a character's limited quest, set up for a normal game on your preferred difficulty level and select that character (luminary/profession), again not using any previously unlocked limited quest rewards.

Note: Limited quests are intended to be very difficult, so it may take you multiple tries to beat them (but don't feel bad about reducing the difficulty setting as needed - it's your game so have fun with it).

Place the limited quest card in easy reach with the side that has the quest's name face up. Follow any setup rules, special instructions and mandatory effects the quest describes. If there are voluntary effects listed, you are allowed to use these the same way you would use effects on your action card.

The Quest Requirements text at the bottom of the card explains what you must do to win the game. This could be simply winning the game as normal, or could present you with a completely different win condition.

If you do not complete the Quest Requirements, you do not unlock its rewards, but you are free to try again in a new game. If you fulfill the Quest Requirements, you have successfully won this character's limited quest! Flip the card over to its reward side permanently!

REWARDS AND FUTURE PLAYS

Once you have beaten a character's limited quest, you can now use the added reward on the reverse side of the card on future plays with that character! You can even combine the limited quest rewards in a game, using an earned reward for both your luminary and profession.

Limited quest rewards typically provide a new effect you now have access to, as if it was on an action card you played or an active skill. Some limited quest rewards will give you special instructions, such as the reward replacing a character's skill on their skill mat.

You can place the limited quest reward anywhere in your player area when playing with it. We have found placing it below where your booster card goes, with the quest reward sticking out below it, is a convenient place.

As you unlock and play with limited quest rewards, your luminaries and professions will become stronger. We recommend increasing your difficulty settings to see if you can reach new heights! You can also try to complete all Limited Quest Achievements.

LIMITED QUEST ACHIEVEMENTS

Limited Quest Achievements refer to winning a game on High Radiance difficulty with each luminary and profession combination. There are 4 luminaries and 4 professions, which means there are 16 combinations to

complete. You are allowed to bring both your luminary and profession's limited quest rewards to the game, provided you have unlocked them.

Once you have beaten High Radiance difficulty with each combination, you have achieved Radiant Elder status. Few in the history of Farhome have ever done so. In fact, you would be the first and only Radiant Elder of your generation. Be proud.

If you are extremely ambitious, you can try to achieve Radiant Elder status against each Shade, which gives 16 x 4 = 64 unique combinations to complete. But we recommend bringing whichever Shade you want into any limited quest achievement game, and focusing instead on simply winning with each luminary and profession combination.

LOCATION BARONS

Created by Ronny Hug

The Location Barons module is a way to add more menacing enemies, called Barons, to the game at certain locations. Barons introduce interesting new mechanics that generate a greater challenge in addition to providing exciting, game-breaking rewards. The twist is: you must defeat Barons in their home location to gain the reward. Barons automatically leave play if you travel away from the location they have dominion over. (**A given Baron's home location will be different every game; the location coordinates printed on the Baron card are for a different purpose, explained later in this section.**)

You can optionally play using the Mandatory Location Baron difficulty rating modifier, which adds +2 to your difficulty rating and forces you to defeat at least 1 Location Baron before the end of the game, or you lose.

You can play with the Barons in one of two ways, each of which modifies setup. With **Random Encounters** you

may cross paths with multiple Barons throughout your journey. In **Quest Encounter**, there is a single Baron in the game which you know from the start and can choose to seek them out for an extra challenge, and extra reward!

SETUP

Gather all Baron cards and flip them to their green Encounter side. Also, place the large Modules Reference Card in view.

1. **Random Encounters:** Randomly select 8 Baron Encounter cards and shuffle them into the location deck, encounter side up. If after shuffling there is an Encounter card on top of the deck, keep shuffling the location deck until there is a location card on top of the deck.

2. **Quest Encounter:** Shuffle all Baron cards together and draw 2 randomly, tucking the second under the first so only the location coordinates (1) are revealed. The top card is your Quest Baron for the game and the bottom card determines at which location the Quest Baron can be found. When you travel to that location, it triggers the Quest Baron encounter.

GAMEPLAY

Note: The following instructions explain the Random Encounters option for playing the Barons module. The rules are the same for the Quest Encounter option, except instead of revealing encounters from the location deck, you reveal the predetermined encounter when you arrive at the location chosen during setup.

When drawing a location card from the location deck, if the card you reveal (the new card on top of the deck) is an Encounter card, you have **triggered a Baron Encounter**. Attach the revealed Encounter card to the location card you just drew. This location is considered the Baron's home location. The Encounter remains attached to this location for the rest of the game until you have defeated the associated Baron, including when you defer, save, discard or travel to the attached location.

Exception: you can optionally ignore any encounters revealed at the Final Location.

Note: if you ever draw a card and there are multiple encounters now on top of the deck, select which encounter you want to attach to the card then shuffle the remaining encounters back into the deck.

Whenever you travel to a location with an attached encounter card, set up the encounter following the instructions printed on the Encounter card. Typically, encounters require you to reveal one or more enemies from the enemy decks and will tell you which enemy (or enemies) you reveal is considered the Baron. For each Baron, take the top enemy from the Doom deck and tuck it under the Baron so the word "Doom" is revealed below the card to denote which enemies in play are Barons.

The encounter may require you to reveal enemies that are not considered Barons. These are still associated with the Baron encounter, however, and will be discarded (along with the Baron) if you travel away from the current location before defeating the Baron, as described below.

In addition to revealing a Baron, the Encounter card may include some special rules. There may even be mandatory effects you must resolve each round or when certain conditions are met. Follow these rules and

effects as long as the encounter is attached to the active location.

If you defeat all Barons before traveling to a new location, flip the Encounter card and receive it as a reward. Put the reward card in your player area. Rewards typically give you access to new effects. Follow the normal rules for resolving effects (see p.26).

If you travel away from the location the Encounter is attached to and there are still Barons in play, discard all Barons in play without receiving their XP rewards, as Barons only care about their home location. Remember that the Encounter remains attached to its location even when it is discarded to the location discard pile.

Reducing the Difficulty: If you are finding Barons too difficult, whenever you reveal a Baron enemy, you may choose whether it has fast ↷ or slow ↶ initiative. Note that if you use this option while playing with the Mandatory Location Baron custom difficulty setting, consider this setting a +1 instead of a +2 difficulty modifier.

TWIN FLAMES (2-PLAYER CO-OP)

Created by Jonathan Fouk

Twin Flames is a way for two players to play the game cooperatively! You need some additional components and must abide by some changes to the rules. These items will be noted below. Assume that everything else not mentioned here about the game remains the same.

COMPONENTS

Use the following additional components for the extra player:

- An extra set of 12 skill cubes
- An additional 7 cubes of a single color

These additional components are provided in the Deluxe Edition of the game, though another alternative is to have 2 copies of the Standard Edition of Radiance.

SHARED VS SEPARATE SYSTEMS

The players will share certain components and areas of play, while others are tracked and maintained separately. For elements noted as shared below, manage these things the same way you do for a solo game.

Shared:

- Enemy Deck
- Location Deck
- Current Location
- Beacons (the party's beacon capacity is the higher of the two Luminaries' beacon capacities)
- Treachery
- Shade (if not playing Blitz Mode)
- Shade Influence Mat

- Shadow(s)
- Quest Area

Separate:

- Corruption mat tracks
- Growth mat tracks
- Player decks
- Hobby market
- Permanent booster market
- Player area [P] (where enemies are engaged)

SETUP

1. Both players go through Character Setup as normal. Each player must pick a unique luminary, profession, and hobby.

2. Both players will pick one of the remaining 2 **luminaries** for their permanent booster source deck.

3. Players will share the Corruption and Growth mats, but use their own colored cube for each track. Set up like normal, assigning each player a different color and using that color to track their place on the mats.

4. Only 1 set of enemy decks (and) and 1 location deck will be used.

5. When seeding initial enemies, seed 3 of enemies **each** into the shared quest area [Q].

DIFFICULTY

The chosen difficulty setting is shared between players. When modifying difficulty, make the same modifications for both players.

GAMEPLAY CHANGES

Note: *We recommend playing in Blitz mode (p.80) for a 2-player game to shorten the playtime.*

1. Staging phase

   a. Starting with the higher-threat player, each player reveals enemies to the shared quest area [Q] based on their total threat (threat track + threat tokens on the location).

2. Action Set Phase

   a. Players will create their action sets, paying light costs to their own light track (with their cube).

3. Engagement Phase

   a. Starting from the player with the lowest light, players take turns engaging enemies into their own personal player area [P] until their engagement requirement is met.

4. Darkness Phase/Explore Phase

   a. Sum the total explore points (EP) between both players, and apply it to cover quest area darkness and towards exploring the location as normal.

   b. A location's explore value (EV) is doubled, so it requires twice the printed value to explore the location. After scaling the printed value, add both players' resistance values to the progress value. (*Example: If the Location explore value is 5 on the card, Player 1 has a resistance of 2, and Player 2 has a resistance of 4, the total explore value will be 5x2 + 2 + 4 = 16.*)

   c. If the location is explored, both players get the XP reward for exploring the location.

5. Travel

   a. Both players travel and make the decisions on

how to travel together. If the players decide to fetch or emergency beacon travel, both players have to pay the XP or threat track costs.

b. Once distance is calculated, both players must advance on their travel track by that distance. Note that this might result in different threat/resistance advancement, since players could have different corruption levels.

c. Beacon Capacity: the party's beacon capacity is the higher of the two luminaries' beacon capacities.

6. Attack Phase

a. If an attack has the ***ranged*** trait, that attack may be split between all player areas as desired. (*Example: Player 1 plays an attack of strength 12 with the* **ranged** *trait. They may spend 5 of their attack to target an enemy in their own player area, and 7 of their attack towards enemies in another player's player area.*)

b. All other attacks made by a player may only target enemies in their own player area.

7. Defend phase

a. All enemies attack the player of the player area they are in. Players can only defend attacks targeting them.

8. Refresh phase

a. Players carry out the refresh phase on their own. Note that this may result in different light/corruption/growth track values.

b. 1 threat token is added to the location as usual.

SHADE ENCOUNTER CHANGES

- When the players reach the final location, reveal the shade as normal. The shade's HP is doubled.

- The Shade Influence modifier affects each player separately, either gaining extra XP or adding additional threat for the reveal round.
- Any special requirements that check for *X* darkness in the quest area are doubled.
- Players win the game when the Shade is defeated and the location is fully explored (unless otherwise stated by the Shade).

ADDITIONAL RULES

Skill Effects - Skill effects that reference your player area can only target your player area.

Push/Pull Effects - Effects that push or pull can push to or pull from another player's player area, as well as the quest area. You can push enemies from your player area to the other player's area or to the quest area. You can pull an enemy from the quest area or from another player's player area to your player area.

"You" effects - An effect that refers to "you" applies only to the player who owns the card or who is engaged with the enemy. If a "you" effect targets the treachery, the players choose who the "you" refers to. If a "you" effect would refer to both players (such as effects on shared spaces, like the location or enemies in the quest area), but can only be resolved by one player, the players decide who "you" refers to. If both players are able to resolve the effect, however, they must do so.

Simultaneous Play - Players take their turns simultaneously.

Corruption - Effects of cards in the quest area that reference corruption reference the highest corruption between both players. Effects in a player area that reference corruption reference the specific player's corruption.

Loss Condition - If either player loses per the game rules (losing all HP, or not having enough light to pay for an action set), both players lose.

Envy Shade changes

- When the final location is reached, take the final location and the 3 locations specified in Envy's setup. Shuffle the 4 locations, and split them evenly between the players' player areas [P]. Each player can only contribute to the locations in their own player area.
- The final location counts as one of Envy's special locations, so Envy is only revealed after all 4 locations are explored.
- During the refresh phase, place a threat token where the location typically sits next to the location deck. This will be used to track location threat for the encounter.

Ravager Shadow - For the first "meddle" effect, place ‼ on the treachery only when a player whose cube is further back on the corruption mat moves forward.

SIDE QUESTS FOR TWIN FLAMES

To play with Side Quests and the Twin Flames mode together, play by following the rules outlined above for each module with the following modifications.

Setup

- The Quest Board holds 10 Quest cards instead of 5.

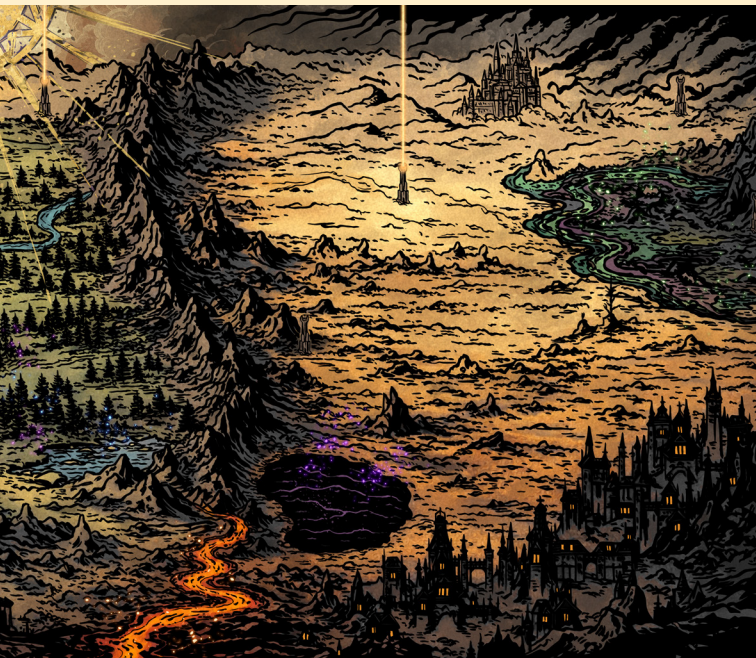
General Rules

- The cost of advancing the Quest Board cube is doubled. You may pay either double the stated XP or EP cost, or pay each of the stated XP and EP costs once.

- Both players may contribute to paying the cost to advance the Quest Board cube. Players do not need to contribute equally.
- After advancing the Quest Board cube, obtain 2 quests instead of 1. Immediately, decide who will undertake the chosen quests (one player may undertake both).
- Quest requirements must be fulfilled by the player who undertook the quest. Quest rewards are awarded to, and can only be used by, the player who undertook the quest. Rewards cannot be shared amongst players.

Mandatory Side Quests

When playing with Mandatory Side Quests (+1 difficulty modifier), you must collectively complete **at least 4** Side Quests before the game ends, or you lose.



LORE

FARHOME

In this world, light and darkness work differently. There is no sun. No stars in the sky. The concept would be foreign to the residents of Farhome. Instead, light is produced by beings. Virtuous people exude light from within. The more virtuous the person, the more brilliant and far-reaching their light. The amount of light a person produces is known as their radiance. The light you produce is extremely important. It is a resource for your work and well-being. Those with the most radiance are capable of impressive physical and photonic feats, and are the most effective of Farhome's citizens.

The opposite is true for evil beings. We are not sure if they consume light or emit darkness. Maybe it's both. Either way, we know that leaving the brightness and safety of Farhome and venturing into the dark always leads to corruption and death.

Hundreds of years before the events of this game take place, there was a devastating conflict known as the War of Shadows. There had always been light places and dark places, and constant struggle between the two. This one was different. It was a coordinated attack. An alliance among every evil faction.

Many theories arose as to why the dark forces suddenly collaborated. The most popular theories cited the Bright Cities' policies of dealing with the outside world. We would send patrols, followed by skirmish forces when necessary, to keep the darkness in check. As our reach expanded, our brightness was stretched thin. And the enemy became more aggressive. Perhaps we created the means of our own destruction. Or maybe it was justified.

Our elders never reached a consensus.

The dark forces were led by a group of terrifying adversaries: the Shades. These were more powerful than the enemies the Bright Cities were used to dealing with. They were not only formidable opponents in combat — many luminaries died by their swords — they were calculated, intelligent and motivated by hatred.

The Bright Cities fought for survival. Every city fell, with the exception of Farhome. In a final, desperate attempt to turn the tide, we sent the last of our luminaries — our mighty warriors of light — on a secret mission to Nul-Gador, the massive fortress of Wrath. Wrath was strongest of the Shades by our accounting, and likely the mind behind the coordinated assault on the Bright Cities.

We who were left in Farhome barricaded the citadel. We

fought with what strength we had left, and we waited. Waited to find out if our luminaries succeeded or failed in their quest. After 3 days, the assault fell silent.

We must have won.

We rebuilt Farhome, brick by brick. We watched the horizon for our luminaries, but they never returned.

From that time onward, we changed our policies. No longer would we send patrols. No more exploration. We would no longer expand our reach or exploit the lands beyond our walls. We were nearly exterminated in the war. We were determined there would never be another.

Hundreds of years later, Farhome shone brighter than ever. We spent the centuries cultivating virtue in our society rather than training luminaries or maintaining armies. The War of Shadows was a terrible, distant memory. The elders old enough to remember refused to speak of it.

No one left the city — not through the gates at least. Our wayfarers occasionally guided small parties to the Remnant Cities to gather news and share supplies. Before the war, the Remnants were Bright Cities like Farhome. Now, they were nothing more than outposts with secret underground contingents of our people. Orseth, Hillcrest, Sol, Druidane, Northwood, Pyrus — cities once brilliant and productive — now little more than waypoints for the enemy.

Farhome remained the only truly safe haven. Bright and sustainable. We produced food and materials from the land and resources inside our walls. The light in Farhome was vast and seemingly eternal.

Then everything changed. Typically there would be the sighting of a dark enemy from the watchtowers once or twice in a decade. Suddenly, the guards were seeing many evil beings every week. Were these scouts?

Soldiers?

We didn't have to wait long for the answer. An attack on the east gate. Then the southern outpost. The sheer brightness of Farhome weakened the enemy's strength. During the assaults, the enemies would shield their eyes and their skin would burn. But would this be enough to protect us forever?

Again, we received an answer. A darkness began to fill the land and sky in the southeast. It grew each day. We knew what was happening. The Shades had returned, whether resurrected by some great evil or traveled from some distant darkness we did not know. But it was clear the enemy was raising an army and planning to destroy the last bastion of light: our beloved Farhome.

It had been centuries since we trained any luminaries. We needed them now more than ever. We had no hope of winning an all-out war. We needed to raise up heroes who could seek out and defeat the Shades before their plans could get any further.

The elders chose the most virtuous among us to be our luminaries. We needed people with as much radiance as possible to travel deep into the darkness and avoid being corrupted or overrun. None of us were trained in exploration or combat, so we chose individuals with professions that would provide skills useful for the quest. Hunters, scorchwrights, menders, wayfarers — these were no soldiers, but they were the closest thing we had.

After briefly training our new generation of luminaries with what knowledge the elders remembered, we opened the gates for the first time in generations. We sent the luminaries to what could only be their ultimate doom.

Farhome's brilliance dimmed a little with their departure.

THE LUMINARIES

COURAGE (COMPLEXITY 4/10)

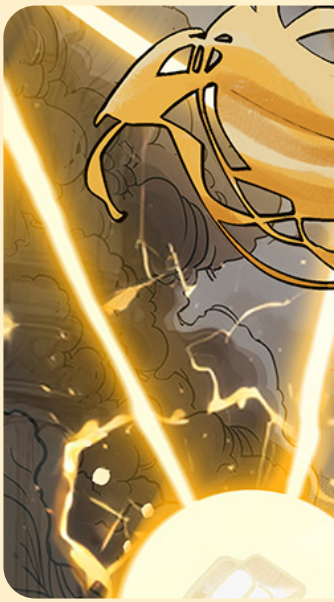
Strengths:

- Straightforward to pilot
- High beacon capacity leads to efficient travel
- Competent attacker
- High flexibility thanks to alternative ways to spend XP and beacons

Weaknesses:

- Loses momentum if she runs out of beacons or XP
- Can get into tight spots if she gets carried away engaging enemies

There is a tradition of renaming luminaries to the virtue they exemplify the most. Courage, then, is aptly named. She's the brightest of the newly-designated generation of light warriors and is able to carry more beacons than her peers. She also has mastered creative methods for using those beacons against her enemies, rather than simply for healing or travel.



Courage is quick to learn from her mistakes. Her enemies curse her ability to use her experience against them, whether she's pulling enemies en masse from the Shadows, accelerating her growth as a luminary, or disarming opponents in her vicinity.

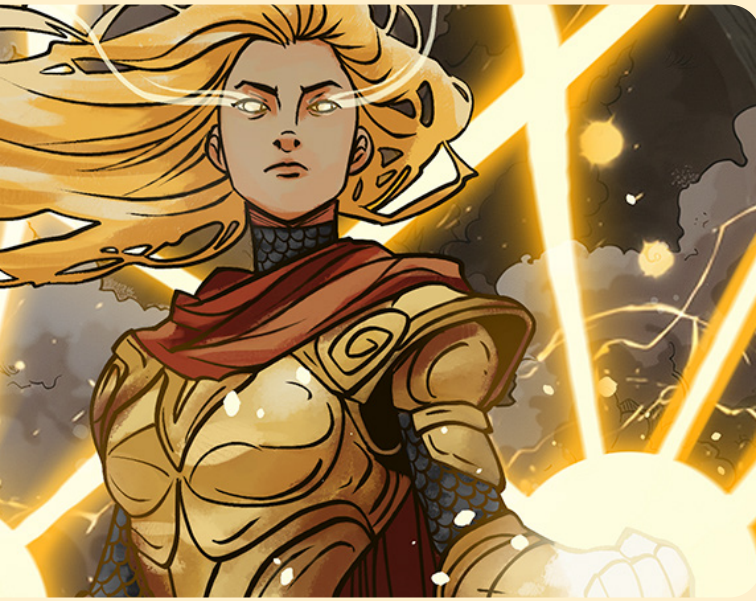
Courage thrives under adversity. She becomes dangerous when she's outnumbered. The elders who trained her tried to ensure she did not take this to the extreme, but they could not shake her belief that, (in her words): *longer odds create shorter battles*.

Strategy Tips

- It's important to always have beacons on hand. One way to ensure this is to travel frequently.
- Use her high beacon capacity to your advantage when traveling to find a good destination.
- Look for Courage's effects that key off of how many enemies are engaged with you if you ever start feeling overrun.

Important Concepts

- Disarm (see p.40)



JUSTICE (COMPLEXITY 5/10)

Strengths:

- The highest HP of any luminary (11)
- Built-in means for extra light production
- Efficient direct damage, if you set it up properly

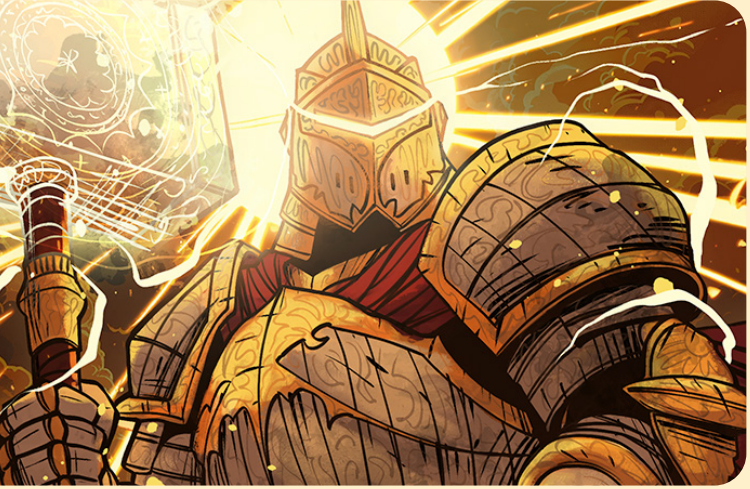
Weaknesses:

- The lowest beacon capacity of any luminary (3) makes him less reliable at travel
- Often gains benefits from dealing himself damage, which results in additional obstacles when photonic healing is needed
- His trait-based attack skills are powerful, but challenging to set up

Justice is not impervious to pain. He just knows how to use it. Where others find wounds distracting, Justice finds clarity. Others are weakened by pain. Justice finds it motivating. He can unleash surprising and devastating attacks when, by all rights, he should be shrinking back from the threat.

But he's not just a blunt instrument. He is surgical with his attacks. He's done his homework. He knows his enemies and their precise weaknesses. Justice can deal extra direct damage based on enemy traits — but he goes even further. He learns his enemy as he fights them. He has the ability to apply traits to his attacks to mirror his enemy's attributes, dealing extra damage with every swing of his hammer.

While the best offense can sometimes replace a good defense, Justice certainly has his flaws. Though chosen above the rest of Farhome's citizens for his virtue, Justice is the dimmest of the new generation of luminaries.



He can carry fewer beacons, which hampers his ability to travel efficiently. This can sometimes lead to a death spiral because that lack of beacon capacity has another consequence: lack of access to photonic healing. To be his best, Justice needs to take a few wounds here and there. If he gets low on health, he can find himself stymied and fighting for survival.

Strategy Tips:

- Many of Justice's more powerful effects rely on him dealing wounds to himself. He has plenty of HP, but you should always have a plan for healing.
- Pay attention to Justice's skills that deal damage based on trait matching. His cards have a good number of traits on them, but you should be able to find ways to grant traits to make these effects more reliable.

Important Concepts:

- Wounds and Healing (see p.36)
- Traits (see p.32)

TEMPERANCE (COMPLEXITY 6/10)

Strengths:

- Can surge out ahead of the difficulty curve early with XP-based buffs
- Powerful synergies with many of the professions
- Seizes control of the board with treachery management, push effects and scouting

Weaknesses:

- Trait-based negative effects can be a challenge to work around
- Many effects rely on stocking up on unspent XP, which creates the threat of growing too slowly

Temperance worked harder than anyone else to reach luminary status. Virtue didn't always come easy. He had to work tirelessly to tame his destructive tendencies and master his own will. He is not perfect; he still struggles with the temptation to backslide and must always be on guard. But he can use the positive traits he's spent years developing to augment his already-impressive abilities as a luminary.

As his namesake would suggest, Temperance is at his

best when he focuses on moderation. In fact, he wields it like a sword and shield. The experience he earns on his quests can be used for traditional growth, like other luminaries. But with the discipline to not spend that XP the instant he earns it, Temperance can fuel powerful skills to put fear into the hearts of his enemies and stay in control of any situation.

Control is what makes Temperance unique among the luminaries. He does not embrace the chaotic strategies that Justice and Courage use so effectively. Temperance prefers to avoid getting into those tight spots entirely by managing threats before they have a chance to get out of hand.

All these skills make Temperance a consistent force against the evil powers. He does not enjoy defeating enemies or venturing into dark landscapes. But his sense of duty compels him to it. And his extreme discipline makes him one of the most effective luminaries of the new generation.

Strategy Tips:

- Store up unspent XP whenever you can to fuel Temperance's most powerful effects.
- Pay close attention to the traits on the cards you play as your action and attack. Some traits make Temperance's effects more efficient, while others lead to a negative outcome.
- Choose a profession that can add traits that might be helpful to your desired strategies with Temperance.

Important Concepts:

- Special text box on luminary mat (see p.8)
- Traits (see p.32)
- Scouting (see p.41)

WISDOM (COMPLEXITY 8/10)

Strengths:

- Tools to support most of the professions
- Ability to set up your most powerful skill element combos
- Your profession's most powerful skill is available at setup
- Can make stealth a top-tier strategy

Weaknesses:

- The lowest HP of any luminary (7)
- Finicky internal combos that are hard to pull off without help from a profession

In a surprising break from tradition, the elders named one of their own as a luminary: Wisdom. Farhome's first elder-luminary was a child during the War of Shadows. He never speaks of it. He doesn't speak much at all, really. But when he does, people listen. He is considered one of the wisest of the elders. Sending him out as a luminary is a move of desperation. Losing Wisdom would be a devastating blow to Farhome. But these are desperate times.

Wisdom is not as strong or as fast as he used to be. He was once both a hunter and a scorchwright. But his eyesight failed him decades ago and his body is weak with age. He makes up for these shortcomings in other ways. Wisdom trained for many years to learn how to put trances on enemies. These create instant benefits Wisdom can use to gain the upper hand. Wisdom can also partially track enemies, and then spend the knowledge he learned for various benefits.

All of this showcases Wisdom's competency in his own right. But he is most notable for empowering his profession to excel. When you need a long-shot strategy or a multi-skill combo to come together, Wisdom is there to help make it happen.

Strategy Tips:

- Remember that when you unlock skills, you can choose skills adjacent to any already-unlocked skill. With Wisdom in play, this means you can access some of your profession's most powerful skills in the early game.
- Wisdom creates a complex economy of both trances attached to enemies and progress tokens on enemies. Consider how you might be able to sequence — and even chain — effects that interact with trances and enemy progress.
- You can choose to focus on Wisdom's self-contained strategies, but he can also be effective in a supporting role for your profession. You may end up spreading yourself too thin if you attempt to accomplish both!

Important Concepts:

- Special text box on luminary mat (see p.8)
- Swapping skill cubes (see p.35)
- Attaching cards (see p.36)

HUNTER (COMPLEXITY 7/10)

Strengths:

- Can seize control of chaotic board states with enough setup time
- Works different angles to provide buffs and benefits while your main strategies are taking place
- Alternative means to gain XP and place progress on the location

Weaknesses:

- Requires patience to set up tracking and trap mechanics
- Corruption is a greater threat if you frequently use traps
- Few effects that directly buff damage or exploration

Hunters are vital to Farhome's existence. There is not enough farmable land inside the city to provide all the food we need. Hunters are tasked with venturing outside the city to hunt. They use stealth tactics, meticulously tracking enemies (in addition to game) to maintain a safe distance, or ambush them with an attack. Hunters are also known for using traps to ensnare game and enemies, helping to keep Farhome safe and sometimes even getting information out of evil beings who are captured.

Strategy Tips:

- Hunter is extremely effective at crowd control using their skills. You may need to rely on your luminary to manage things while you take the time needed to set up your hunter combos.
- Don't underestimate the value of the effects individual traps can provide while they are attached to enemies.

- Find creative ways to increase your explore booster values to maximize the power of Hunter's main strategies.

Important Concepts:

- Tracked enemies (see p.41)
- Trapped enemies (see p.41)
- Recruit (see p.41)

MENDER (COMPLEXITY 9/10)

Strengths:

- The most reliable source of healing in the game
- Extreme element flexibility
- Becomes extremely strong in the late game

Weaknesses:

- **Dark Past** skill can get you into trouble
- Exceedingly complex to pilot effectively
- Often in danger of corruption due to discard mechanics

Menders are warriors first and healers second. Or at least they used to be, back when Farhome would send patrols. In the centuries that followed the War of Shadows, Menders were relegated mainly to the role of healer. But their true potential is once again on display since we've seen the need to raise up the new generation of luminaries.

Menders use their wounds against the enemy, redirecting the damage back to the enemy as they heal. They can also use their terrifying **Songs of Battle** to use their own defensive abilities as a way to levy unblockable attacks against their enemies.

Menders are also masters of the elements. They can adapt to the shifting availability of elements, making it more realistic for them to leverage all the complex skills in their arsenal for devastating combos.

Though the mender is one of the most powerful and flexible professions a luminary can have, it comes at a cost. Most menders have a dark past that most in the profession would prefer to forget. But instead of hiding

from it, they use it. It's what drives them to become some of the fiercest light warriors we have.

Strategy Tips:

- Learn how to get the most from the **Enduring Hope** skill to greenlight your best skill combos even if they don't share an element.
- Mender's **Countervail** skill can be a reliable way to get the effect you need at the right time.
- Mender's **Dark Past** skill can be pretty penalizing. What if there was a way to make it work for you instead of against you?

Important Concepts:

- Healing and Wounds (see p.36)
- Mandatory effects (see p.26)
- Clones (see p.39)
- Mill (see p.40)
- Echo (see p.33)

SCORCHWRIGHT (COMPLEXITY 7/10)

Strengths:

- Flexibility to specialize in either damage output or travel (or a little of both)
- Direct damage opportunities
- Reliable obstacle removal for less painful beacon use

Weaknesses:

- Requires skill, patience and intentionality to pull off strongest skill combos
- Relies on attachments, which can accelerate corruption
- Damage from fire attachments happens after enemies have had a chance to attack

Scorchwrights typically are not warriors. We have of course repurposed the profession since the new threats emerged, but historically scorchwrights have an important, but peaceful, purpose in Farhome society. Fire, in this universe, needs photonic energy to ignite and sustain it. The more fire you need, the more skill is required. Most of Farhome's citizens can ignite and sustain their own home's fireplace. Larger or more complex fires require assistance from a scorchwright. Burning waste, clearing fields, lighting the watchtowers. Even the torches wielded by the wayfarers. The Scorchwrights are trained to handle what the average citizen cannot.

For fire to provide light, one needs to infuse it with photonic energy. This is another reason the scorchwrights are so critical to society. To keep light

present where a person's radiance is not, fire is required. And scorchwrights are the only ones who can manage this complex task. Scorchwrights can use fire as a way to magnify the efficiency of light produced. Scorchwrights can also keep fires going from a distance, allowing a single scorchwright to power multiple watchtower fires or many torches in a company.

When the Shades re-emerged and we knew we needed to train new luminaries, scorchwright was the first profession mentioned in the elders' conversations. It seemed crude or cruel to some, but in this fight for survival, everyone knew in their hearts that fire would be an effective weapon against the enemy, and one the enemy could not wield themselves or efficiently defend against.

Strategy Tips:

- Scorchwright's main strategies revolve around dealing damage and traveling by attaching fire cards. These can be hard combos to set up, but once you do, it can change the game.
- The **Burnout** skill resolves in the refresh phase, which means enemies get to attack you before it resolves. Find creative ways to get around this — or at least make it worth the cost.
- Scorchwright can excel at both damage output and travel. Consider which you need more of in your game.

Important Concepts:

- Traits (see p.32)
- Attaching cards (see p.36)
- When a location is considered explored (see p.54)

WAYFARER (COMPLEXITY 5/10)

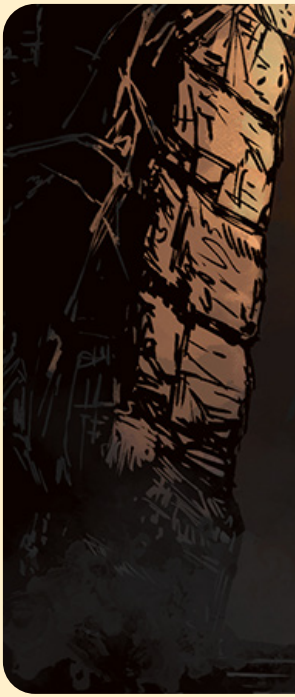
Strengths:

- Straightforward to pilot compared to other professions
- Drastically reduce distance when traveling
- One of the game's most powerful disarm effects in **Field Advantage**

Weaknesses:

- Weak when it comes to attack
- Requires planning to set up trait matches with the location, which feeds many of Wayfarer's effects

Few venture outside the city, but when there is need, wayfarers are the ones who make it possible. They are experts in navigating secret paths and tunnels. They know shortcuts from one place to another, getting you to your destination more quickly. Everyone from hunters seeking game to wardens checking on outpost communities rely on wayfarers to get them where they are going safely.



Though they are expert guides, even wayfarers sometimes struggle maintaining their sense of directions in certain circumstances. The darkness is disorienting. But as long as they can figure out where they currently are, or can find their way to familiar territory, you will find no better guides.

Strategy Tips:

- Wayfarer loves matching their cards' traits with those of the active location. Keep this in mind when choosing travel destinations and when upgrading cards.
- Wayfarer has your travel distance mitigation covered. This can free you up to go all in on your luminary's favorite strategies.

Important Concepts:

- Traits (see p.32)
- Deferring locations during travel (see p.57)
- Resolving distance during travel (see p.58)

THE SHADES

GREED (COMPLEXITY 3/10)

Strengths:

- Puts you on a short timer with limits at 5 corruption and 3 completed treacheries
- Is slow initiative, so it requires some effort to engage him

Weaknesses:

- Lowest stats of all the Shades
- Does not have a detrimental ability like other Shades do
- Makes the location deck easier by removing the furthest locations

Greed has not accomplished much in his life, but he doesn't care. He can feed off of the accomplishments and experiences of others, leaching vitality and photonic energy from them like a dark parasite. It's what gives him purpose and power. As his name would suggest, he really enjoys this power. And he'll do anything to get more.

He is less careful than the other Shades, making his home in various places, often closer to Farhome than the other Shades would dare. He roams between **Northwood**, **Sol** and **Garadeth**. He likes these places because they

were once Bright Cities, and there remains a remnant of photonic energy for him to feed on.

Greed is the most impatient of the Shades. He will make his advance on any questing luminaries he discovers, perhaps more quickly than he ought. He justifies this by pointing out that this also means the luminary is not as ready for the fight either, so it equals out. He might be right.

When Greed does encounter a luminary, he has one prominent weakness: the luminary can tempt him with XP, drawing him from the safety of the shadows. Greed is not bothered by this. He assumes he has the strength to take on the luminary anyway. And, once again, it may turn out that his assumption is correct.

PRIDE (COMPLEXITY 5/10)

Strengths:

- Can be tricky or costly to find
- High attack and darkness stats
- Buffs enemy attacks

Weaknesses

- You can keep her at a distance for no cost, though you must always consider her high darkness value

Pride is extremely powerful. Her only weakness is that she knows it. Wrath, in fact, considers her a loose cannon. Pride couldn't care less.

She is notorious for charging into conflicts herself when the plan called for the underlings to wear down the luminaries first before the Shades intervened. Even with this defect, Pride is among the most feared of the Shades.

Pride makes her home in **Molta**, which she is tasked with guarding. She can be drawn away from her post, though, if she feels the momentum of completing a treachery. She'll seek out luminaries to defeat in neighboring locations in such cases.

As a warrior, Pride exceeds even Wrath. Her zeal for darkness makes her presence formidable even from a distance. Her skills in combat are devastating. And her ability to bolster the morale of underlings in battle heighten the pressure she places on the forces of light.

She tries to hang back and allow the underlings to weaken luminaries before she herself delves into battle. But if the luminaries appear to be making too much progress, she can't help herself. She becomes quick to join the fray. Wrath continuously warns her that this impulsivity will one day lead to her fall.

Pride will believe that when she sees it.

ENVY (COMPLEXITY 6/10)

Strengths:

- Uses locations and other enemies to prevent you from attacking her
- Requires you to solve a puzzle of exploring special locations

Weaknesses

- Relatively weak in stats compared to other Shades

Envy understands where real power comes from, unlike the other Shades. They're naive. Power is not in physical strength or photonic prowess. It's about influence and your environment. How much control do you have over the world around you?

Envy never was the most intimidating presence among her peers. But she was driven. She longed for the power they had, but she needed other means to get it. So she mastered the land. She learned how to get others to fight her battles for her. She worked tirelessly to make up for her weakness, until she ultimately grew to be one of the most notable and powerful Shades the darkness had ever seen.

You can overpower her, but you will never outmaneuver her. She's too smart for that. She has the power she always longed for — but she wants more. And she's coming for everything you have.

WRATH (COMPLEXITY 8/10)

Strengths:

- High defense and HP
- Unpredictable attack values
- Hits you with an extremely powerful and unpredicatable negative effect each round

Weaknesses:

- More predictable to defend using cards because he has both attack types
- Relatively low darkness compared to the other Shades

Wrath is not only the mightiest and most maniacal warrior of any Shade Farhome has ever encountered, he's also the most brilliant tactician. He rose to leadership centuries ago, seizing it by unseating the previous ruler of the Shades. This was an immense task that required

Wrath to fully lean into his inner anger and feed on the very violence his many exhibitions produced. And still he was lucky — the ruling Shade had been betrayed by another plotting competitor within minutes of Wrath's own attack. Wrath, of course, had to dispatch this competing upstart as well, but he respected their initiative. And he knew, even if his followers perhaps didn't, that without this lucky break, Wrath would never have been able to pull off his coup successfully.

And this fact eats at him to this day. He was good — but he had also benefited from chance. Maybe this was a sign of his adequacy; a sign of photonic abilities that he used subconsciously and did not yet recognize. Which means perhaps he could count on this "ability" to be there in critical moments in the future?

Or maybe it was exactly what it looked like: luck.

This uncertainty, along with the paranoia that comes hand-in-hand with being in power, drives him daily to the edge of madness. He does not like to fight — that's typically an unnecessary risk. He could be wounded and therefore susceptible to attacks from usurpers. But when threats knock at his door, he answers.

His madness only makes him more dangerous. Wild swings with his mace make his attacks erratic but deadly. He unleashes unpredictable photonic disruptions that can devastate his opponents and turn the tide of any battle in a single moment. Rumors say not even Wrath can control these anomalies, though he tells his followers otherwise. But it doesn't matter, because this unpredictable power makes him the darkest and deadliest Shade to ever sit on the throne of Nul-Gador.

ICONOGRAPHY

- Basic player card
- Advanced player card
- Slow enemy
- Fast enemy
- Physical attack
- Photonic attack
- Player card defense
- Enemy physical defense (also indicates enemy attack is physical)
- -Enemy photonic defense (also indicates enemy attack is photonic)
- Wind element
- Fire element
- Earth element
- Progress
- Enemy darkness value
- Enemy attack value
- Player main attack value
- Player attack booster
- Player main explore value
- Player explore booster
- XP
- Quest area
- Player area
- Wound
- HP
- Distance
- Path
- Obstacle
- Light
- Beacon
- Unlocked skill/unlock a skill
- locked skill
- Threat/threat track
- Resistance track
- Corruption
- Ability Growth track
- Character Growth track
- Enemy engagements
- Flip condition (found on companions)
- Upgrade a player card
- Recruit a player card from your hobby deck
- Gain a permanent booster
- Physical rest value
- Hand size
- Destroy effect
- Exhaust effect
- Threat token
- Card action
- Dusk enemy
- Doom enemy

Enemy factions:

Cabalist ( )

Disruptor ( )

Plotter ( )

Prowler ( )

- Shade

- Shadow

- Companion

1X -Once-per-round (1x) effects (may also be eager ✓1X:, mandatory ⚠1X:, or both ✓⚠1X:)

▶▶ - Unrestricted effect (may also be eager ✓▶▶:, mandatory ⚠▶▶:, or both ✓⚠▶▶:)

∞ - Passive effect (mandatory by default. May also be eager ✓∞:)

CREDITS

Publisher: Best with 1 Games

Game Design: Joe Klipfel

Art: Cole Munro-Chity

Graphic Design: Drew Corkill

Rules Editing: Dan Wackwitz

Playtesters:

- Ivan Lo, *Keeper of Quests*
- Jonathan Fouk, *Breaker of Games*
- Ronny Hug, *Baronmaker*
- Trevor Claiborne, *Master of Lore*
- Osama Burhani, *Bringer of Justice*
- Trent Denison, *Dispatcher of Pests*
- John Appel, *The Wandering Wayfarer*

Design Influences:

- Mistfall, *NSKN Games*
- Lord of the Rings: The Card Game, *Fantasy Flight Games*
- Marvel Champions: The Card Game, *Fanstasy Flight Games*
- Dragons of Etchinstone, *Chip Theory Games*

KEYWORDS (P.39)

Clone - A temporary and virtual copy of the card being cloned. Effects cannot change anything on a clone.

(Your) Collection – Any Radiance components you own but were not in the game at setup.

Cycle - Put the card on the bottom of the appropriate deck.

Disarm - Chosen enemy does not attack this round.

Discard - Put the component in question from in play to its designated discard area.

Echo - The top card of your discard pile.

Engage - When an enemy moves to your player area [P] in the Engagement Phase.

Mill - Move the required number of cards from the top of your deck to the top of your discard pile.

Push - Move chosen enemy in your player area [P] to the quest area [Q], respecting ↷ and ↶ when placing.

Pull - Move chosen enemy from the quest area [Q] to your player area [P].

Recruit - Add a card from your hobby market to hand, refreshing the hobby market.

Regenerate *X* - Move ***X*** cards from the **bottom** of your discard pile to the **bottom** of your deck.

Reveal - Flip over the top card of the appropriate deck and place it in its appropriate position.

Scout *X* - Look at the top ***X*** cards from the relevant deck and return them to the top in the same order.

Tracked - When the number of progress tokens !! on an enemy equals (or exceeds) their darkness value ◈.

Trapped/Tranced - Enemies are considered trapped or tranced when there is a card with the ***trap*** or ***trance*** trait attached to them, respectively.

Upon Arrival Effects - Resolve such an effect one time immediately after resolving a travel ending here.